

# Arithmetic structure of the standard genetic code

Ruslan Khafizov

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## Abstract

The standard genetic code is near-universal and stable over evolutionary time, motivating study of its arithmetic properties. We analyze proton and neutron counts of the encoded amino acids (free neutral forms) across 33 codon groups constructed from two natural grouping systems: the Rumer partition by family degeneracy and the three chemical axes of the third codon position (Keto/Amino, Strong/Weak, Purine/Pyrimidine). Excluding the three stop codons and the initiator ATG leaves 60 codons whose group sums determine an arithmetic structure modulo 37. Neutron counts reach the 37-lattice, whereas necessarily even proton counts, barred from odd multiples of 37, fall one below them: globally, and in the single tryptophan/iso-leucine pair carrying the Keto/Amino asymmetry, with differences 37 and 36. The Keto/Amino balances and global conditions yield separate neutron and proton equations modulo 37, the former containing  $111 = 3 \cdot 37$ ; since  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$ , these equations fix a unique minimal non-negative integer assignment for the four service codons, after which the regularities form a connected family of identities and divisibilities. Across 27 NCBI translation tables, this combination occurs only in the standard code and its exact codon-to-amino-acid equivalent; deterministic controls show divisibilities concentrated in third-position groupings, with 37 standing out among tested prime moduli. Under a random-code null, the observed values of several arithmetic features of this structure fall in the far tails of their Monte Carlo null distributions. Throughout, the regularities are properties of codon-group sums, not individual amino acids, and depend jointly on codon degeneracy and nucleon composition.

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# 1 Introduction

The genetic code is one of the most ancient and conserved molecular features of cellular organisms. Its near-complete universality across the known domains of life, and the limited scope of variation in the known alternative codes, indicate that the basic structure of the standard code was already established at the early stages of biological evolution. Any organizational regularities present in its arithmetic structure therefore require precise analysis as one of the few potential sources of information about the early stages of life.

The arithmetic structure of the standard genetic code has been studied since shortly after its decipherment. Yu. B. Rumer [6, 7] introduced the partition of the 64 codons into two classes of 32 codons each, Octet I (the eight four-fold degenerate families) and Octet II (the remaining codons), related by the involution  $R = (T \leftrightarrow G, C \leftrightarrow A)$ . Shcherbak and Makukov [8] observed that the number 37 plays a recurrent role in the arithmetic of the code, appearing as a divisor of amino acid nucleon sums across various groupings of codons. Panov and Filatov [5] revisited this analysis, introducing the per-codon counting rule, which forms the methodological basis of the present study.

The present analysis uses the proton and neutron counts of the twenty canonical amino acids in their free neutral forms under the most-abundant-isotope convention; once these conventions are fixed, the counts are uniquely determined. These quantities are considered together with two natural grouping systems defined independently of the nucleon arithmetic. The first is the Rumer partition. The second is given by the three chemical axes of the third codon position — Keto/Amino, Strong/Weak, and Purine/Pyrimidine — which exhaust the partitions of the four nucleotide bases into two pairs and correspond to the functional-group, hydrogen-bond, and ring-topology dichotomies of nucleobase chemistry.

The present work shows that within this framework the arithmetic regularities of the standard genetic code organize into a connected family of identities and divisibilities. The analysis traces this connected structure to a small number of empirical properties of the standard code. The same

arithmetic criteria are then applied to all 27 NCBI translation tables. Among them, the tested combination of structural regularities occurs only in the standard genetic code table and in its exact equivalent with respect to codon-to-amino-acid mapping. The specificity of the structure is examined further by deterministic controls, which test its dependence on the third codon position, on the modulus, and on the molecular representation of the amino acids, and by a Monte Carlo test against an explicit random-code null model.

The analysis is divided into three levels. The principal regularities are established at a parametrization-independent level, at which the three stop codons and ATG in its initiator role are excluded and only the remaining 60 codons are summed; these are the central results of the paper, and they involve no assigned values. To obtain sums for the complete table of 64 codons, however, the four service codons must be given some nucleon contributions. The second level is the naive reading (Key 0), in which the stop codons are assigned zero and ATG is counted as methionine. Assigning zero is also a choice of value, not the absence of one. The third level is the symmetrization (Key 1), in which the four service codons carry derived nucleon contributions. Key 1 does not establish the parametrization-independent core of the structure: that core is already present in sums over the 60 codons remaining after the service codons are excluded. The role of Key 1 is to show how the structure extends to the complete table, taking into account the fixed distribution of the service codons across the groups in the standard code. For the chosen symmetry conditions, these contributions are determined as the unique minimal non-negative integer solution of the corresponding system (Section 3), and the resulting regularities are consequences of that solution.

Assigning values to the service codons is a formal device for treating the arithmetic of the complete table as a single object; neither the assigned values nor the sums that include them are given a physical interpretation.

## 2 Methods

This section defines the nucleon parameters, the codon group systematics, and the parametrizations of service codons used throughout the analysis, together with the computed datasets supporting it.

### 2.1 Nucleon composition of amino acids

Throughout this work, each of the twenty canonical amino acids is represented as a free neutral amino acid molecule (not as a residue in a peptide chain), with its molecular formula retrieved from the PUBCHEM compound database [3]. From this formula, we compute four integer quantities that characterize the nucleon content of the molecule. Below,  $Q(a)$  denotes any of the four quantities  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , or  $\Delta$  for one molecule of amino acid  $a$ . The sensitivity of the results to this choice of molecular representation is examined in Section 4.2.

The proton count  $P$  is defined from the elemental composition of the molecular formula as

$$P = \sum_E n_E Z_E,$$

where  $n_E$  is the number of atoms of element  $E$  in the formula and  $Z_E$  is its atomic number. The atomic numbers used are  $Z(\text{H}) = 1$ ,  $Z(\text{C}) = 6$ ,  $Z(\text{N}) = 7$ ,  $Z(\text{O}) = 8$  and  $Z(\text{S}) = 16$ .

The neutron count  $N$  is computed by assigning each element its most abundant naturally occurring stable isotope, using the terrestrial isotopic compositions evaluated by IUPAC [1]. Accordingly, we use  $^1\text{H}$ ,  $^{12}\text{C}$ ,  $^{14}\text{N}$ ,  $^{16}\text{O}$  and  $^{32}\text{S}$ . The total neutron count is

$$N = \sum_E n_E (A_E - Z_E),$$

where  $A_E$  is the mass number of the selected isotope of element  $E$ .

The total nucleon count  $T$  and the proton–neutron difference  $\Delta$  are defined as

$$T = P + N, \quad \Delta = P - N.$$

Both quantities are integers by construction. Under the isotope assumptions above, hydrogen is the only element contributing to  $\Delta$ , since all other isotopes used have equal numbers of protons and neutrons. Consequently,  $\Delta$  is numerically equal to the number of hydrogen atoms in the molecule and, in particular,  $\Delta \geq 0$  for each of the twenty canonical amino acids. By linearity, the same identity holds for any sum of canonical amino-acid contributions and, in particular, for all group sums over the service-excluded pool (Section 2.2).

To avoid a notational collision, we use uppercase  $\Delta$  exclusively for the proton–neutron imbalance of a single molecule or codon group, and reserve lowercase  $\delta$  for pairwise differences between two such objects (for example,  $\delta P = P_i - P_j$  between two amino acids  $i$  and  $j$ ). When both amino acids are identified explicitly, their labels are placed in parentheses:

$$\delta Q(a, b) = Q(a) - Q(b).$$

We emphasize that  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$  and  $\Delta$  are not measured molecular masses. They are exact integer quantities derived from elemental composition, and all arithmetic identities reported in this study are exact integer relations rather than artifacts of rounding approximate molecular masses.

The nucleon values for all twenty canonical amino acids are collected in the input dataset `amino_acids_nucleons.csv`, with one row per amino acid and columns for  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$  and  $\Delta$ . From this table we compute three companion datasets of pairwise absolute differences: `amino_acids_proton_differences.csv`, `amino_acids_neutron_differences.csv` and `amino_acids_nucleon_differences.csv`. For any pair of amino acids  $(i, j)$  we write  $\delta P = P_i - P_j$  and analogously for  $N$  and  $T$ . Each file groups all  $\binom{20}{2} = 190$  unordered pairs  $(i, j)$  by the corresponding absolute difference  $|\delta P(i, j)|$ ,  $|\delta N(i, j)|$ , or  $|\delta T(i, j)|$ .

All subsequent nucleon computations for codon groups reduce, by linearity, to sums of the per-amino-acid values tabulated in `amino_acids_nucleons.csv`, weighted by the multiplicities of the corresponding codons. Where service codons are included, their contributions are determined by the chosen parametrization (Section 2.4).

## 2.2 Genetic code structure

The standard genetic code maps the 64 codons of the four-letter nucleotide alphabet  $\{A, T, G, C\}$  onto the twenty canonical amino acids and a translation-termination signal. Throughout this paper, we use DNA notation (with thymine T rather than uracil U) and adopt the codon assignments of The Standard Code (NCBI translation table 1) [4]. The three codons TAA, TAG and TGA act as stop signals, whereas ATG encodes methionine and serves as the canonical translation-initiation signal. For the purposes of the present arithmetic analysis, these four codons — the three stop codons and ATG in its initiator role — are referred to as *service codons*. Among possible initiation codons, ATG is predominant. Its RNA equivalent AUG is the only one of them fully complementary to the CAU anticodon of the initiator methionine tRNA. In the present analysis, ATG represents the initiation function; this analytical convention does not exclude initiation from other codons.

Let the complete set of 64 codons be

$$\mathcal{C}_{64} = \{A, T, G, C\}^3,$$

and let the four service codons form the set

$$\mathcal{S} = \{\text{ATG}, \text{TAA}, \text{TAG}, \text{TGA}\}.$$

The *service-codon-excluded 60-codon pool* is then defined as

$$\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}} = \mathcal{C}_{64} \setminus \mathcal{S},$$

with  $|\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}| = 60$ . Every codon belonging to  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$  is counted according to its standard amino-acid assignment. Because ATG is the sole methionine codon,  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$  contains codons for nineteen canonical amino acids; methionine is absent from this pool. The full codon-to-product mapping is provided in the dataset `genetic_code_codons.csv`.

By a codon family, we mean the set of four codons sharing the same first two bases and having an arbitrary third-position base, denoted by N. A structural property of the standard code, first identified by Rumer [6, 7], is the partition of the 64 codons into two halves of 32 codons each, distinguished by the degeneracy pattern of the third codon position. The first half, which we denote *Octet I*, consists of the eight codon families in which all four third-position nucleotides encode the same amino acid. These fully four-fold degenerate families are GCN (Ala), CGN (Arg), GGN (Gly), CCN (Pro), ACN (Thr), GTN (Val), CTN (Leu) and TCN (Ser). The second half, denoted *Octet II*, consists of the remaining eight codon families, in which the third-position nucleotide affects the encoded product. Every service codon of the standard code belongs to Octet II and carries a purine (A or G) at the third position.

The Rumer partition is not an analytical construct introduced in the present work but a structural feature of the code itself. It reflects both the qualitative distinction between fully and partially degenerate codon families and the quantitative fact that these two classes have equal cardinality: each contains eight families and thirty-two codons. Because Octet I contains no service codons, all nucleon quantities computed over Octet I are independent of any parametrization of start and stop signals and are determined solely by the nucleon content of the encoded amino acids. The same property holds, for a separate reason, for any codon group whose third-position nucleotide is restricted to pyrimidines (cytosine or thymine), since all four service codons of the standard code carry a purine at the third position. Full four-fold degeneracy and a purine-free third position are two distinct structural conditions, but both have the same consequence: nucleon quantities over the corresponding groups are fixed by their amino-acid composition and provide parametrization-independent reference values for the arithmetic identities of Section 3.

A further structural property of the Rumer partition, introduced by Rumer [7], is that the two octets are related by a simple permutation of the nucleotide alphabet. Under the transformation

$$R = (\text{T} \leftrightarrow \text{G}, \text{C} \leftrightarrow \text{A}),$$

each codon family of Octet I is mapped to a codon family of Octet II, and vice versa. This transformation, known as the Rumer transformation, rearranges the partition but does not preserve the amino acids encoded by individual codons.

Taken together, the four-fold degeneracy pattern and the Rumer transformation identify the Octet I / Octet II partition as a natural structural division of the standard code, independent of the nucleon arithmetic. In the present work, this division is used as a reference partition over which nucleon quantities are computed and compared.

The codon table (Figure 1) is displayed with its axes in the base ordering  $C, G, T, A$ , which is also the default ordering of the accompanying visualizer. This ordering has two justifications. Chemically, it was introduced by Rumer [7] on the basis of base type and the number of hydrogen bonds in the canonical base pair. The sequence  $C, G, T, A$  alternates pyrimidines and purines, while within each of these classes the member of the Strong pair  $\{C, G\}$  precedes the member of the Weak pair  $\{T, A\}$ : C precedes T among the pyrimidines, and G precedes A among the purines. Geometrically, as shown by Panov and Filatov [5], it is one of exactly four orderings (out of 24 possible permutations of the four bases) in which Octet I and Octet II form connected regions on the codon matrix.

To assess the extent to which the arithmetic properties studied in this paper are specific to the standard genetic code, we additionally retrieved the full set of 27 translation tables maintained

by NCBI [4]. The tables are numbered 1–33, with some numbers left unused, and cover nuclear, mitochondrial and plastid codes across a broad taxonomic range. The codon assignments of all these tables are collected in the dataset `ncbi_genetic_code_registry.csv` and are used in Section 4.1 to compare the standard code with the other NCBI translation tables.

|   | C   |            |          | G   |            |           | T   |            |          | A   |            |          |
|---|-----|------------|----------|-----|------------|-----------|-----|------------|----------|-----|------------|----------|
| C | CCC | Pro<br>115 | 62<br>53 | CGC | Arg<br>174 | 94<br>80  | CTC | Leu<br>131 | 72<br>59 | CAC | His<br>155 | 82<br>73 |
|   | CCG | Pro<br>115 | 62<br>53 | CGG | Arg<br>174 | 94<br>80  | CTG | Leu<br>131 | 72<br>59 | CAG | Gln<br>146 | 78<br>68 |
|   | CCT | Pro<br>115 | 62<br>53 | CGT | Arg<br>174 | 94<br>80  | CTT | Leu<br>131 | 72<br>59 | CAT | His<br>155 | 82<br>73 |
|   | CCA | Pro<br>115 | 62<br>53 | CGA | Arg<br>174 | 94<br>80  | CTA | Leu<br>131 | 72<br>59 | CAA | Gln<br>146 | 78<br>68 |
| G | GCC | Ala<br>89  | 48<br>41 | GGC | Gly<br>75  | 40<br>35  | GTC | Val<br>117 | 64<br>53 | GAC | Asp<br>133 | 70<br>63 |
|   | GCG | Ala<br>89  | 48<br>41 | GGG | Gly<br>75  | 40<br>35  | GTG | Val<br>117 | 64<br>53 | GAG | Glu<br>147 | 78<br>69 |
|   | GCT | Ala<br>89  | 48<br>41 | GGT | Gly<br>75  | 40<br>35  | GTT | Val<br>117 | 64<br>53 | GAT | Asp<br>133 | 70<br>63 |
|   | GCA | Ala<br>89  | 48<br>41 | GGA | Gly<br>75  | 40<br>35  | GTA | Val<br>117 | 64<br>53 | GAA | Glu<br>147 | 78<br>69 |
| T | TCC | Ser<br>105 | 56<br>49 | TGC | Cys<br>121 | 64<br>57  | TTC | Phe<br>165 | 88<br>77 | TAC | Tyr<br>181 | 96<br>85 |
|   | TCG | Ser<br>105 | 56<br>49 | TGG | Trp<br>204 | 108<br>96 | TTG | Leu<br>131 | 72<br>59 | TAG | STOP<br>0  | 0<br>0   |
|   | TCT | Ser<br>105 | 56<br>49 | TGT | Cys<br>121 | 64<br>57  | TTT | Phe<br>165 | 88<br>77 | TAT | Tyr<br>181 | 96<br>85 |
|   | TCA | Ser<br>105 | 56<br>49 | TGA | STOP<br>0  | 0<br>0    | TTA | Leu<br>131 | 72<br>59 | TAA | STOP<br>0  | 0<br>0   |
| A | ACC | Thr<br>119 | 64<br>55 | AGC | Ser<br>105 | 56<br>49  | ATC | Ile<br>131 | 72<br>59 | AAC | Asn<br>132 | 70<br>62 |
|   | ACG | Thr<br>119 | 64<br>55 | AGG | Arg<br>174 | 94<br>80  | ATG | Met<br>149 | 80<br>69 | AAG | Lys<br>146 | 80<br>66 |
|   | ACT | Thr<br>119 | 64<br>55 | AGT | Ser<br>105 | 56<br>49  | ATT | Ile<br>131 | 72<br>59 | AAT | Asn<br>132 | 70<br>62 |
|   | ACA | Thr<br>119 | 64<br>55 | AGA | Arg<br>174 | 94<br>80  | ATA | Ile<br>131 | 72<br>59 | AAA | Lys<br>146 | 80<br>66 |

Figure 1: Standard genetic code with nucleon parameters of the encoded amino acids, displayed under the naive reading (Key 0), in which stop codons contribute zero and ATG is counted as methionine. In each cell, the codon appears on the left; the symbol of the encoded product (the three-letter amino acid symbol or STOP for the three stop codons) appears at the top center; the total nucleon count  $T$  appears below the product symbol; the proton count  $P$  appears at the top right; and the neutron count  $N$  appears at the bottom right. Codons of Octet I (the eight fully four-fold degenerate families) are shaded purple, and codons of Octet II are shaded yellow. Generated by the accompanying `visualization.html`.

### 2.3 Codon-group construction

In addition to the Rumer partition introduced in Section 2.2, we use an additional overlapping grouping system based on the chemical identity of the nucleotide at the third codon position. Each of the four nucleotides belongs to one of two classes under each of three distinct binary chemical classifications:

- base type: *purine* {A, G} (R) or *pyrimidine* {C, T} (Y);



- number of hydrogen bonds in the canonical base pair: *strong* {C, G} (S; three bonds) or *weak* {A, T} (W; two bonds);
- functional class: *amino* {A, C} (M) or *keto* {G, T} (K).

These axes were not selected in response to the subsequent nucleon calculations: they are three conventional pairwise dichotomies of the nucleotides and are represented explicitly in the IUPAC–IUB ambiguity nomenclature by the symbol pairs R/Y, S/W, and M/K. Together they exhaust the three possible partitions of four nucleotides into two unordered pairs, thereby yielding six two-element subsets  $X \subset \{A, T, G, C\}$ .

For each of these six two-element subsets, and for each singleton  $X \in \{\{A\}, \{C\}, \{G\}, \{T\}\}$ , we define the codon group

$$G_X = \{(c_1, c_2, c_3) \in \mathcal{C}_{64} : c_3 \in X\}.$$

Thus,  $G_X$  consists of all codons whose third-position nucleotide belongs to  $X$ . The six two-nucleotide groups overlap: every codon belongs to exactly three of them, one for each chemical classification. At the same time, every codon belongs to exactly one of the four one-nucleotide groups.

This grouping system is applied at three levels: to all 64 codons, to the 32 codons of Octet I, and to the 32 codons of Octet II. If  $|X| = 2$ , then  $G_X$  contains 32 codons, while each of the intersections  $G_X \cap \text{Octet I}$  and  $G_X \cap \text{Octet II}$  contains 16 codons. If  $|X| = 1$ , the corresponding sizes are 16 and 8 codons. Group size alone does not identify a particular group; formulas therefore specify the set  $X$  and, where necessary, the octet explicitly.

The family of 33 codon groups used in the present work comprises the full code as one group of 64 codons; the two octets as groups of 32 codons each; ten groups  $G_X$  at the full-code level, corresponding to the six two-nucleotide and four one-nucleotide sets  $X$ ; and their twenty intersections with Octet I and Octet II. Thus, the total number of analyzed groups is

$$1 + 2 + 10 + 20 = 33.$$

For example,  $G_{\{G,T\}} \cap \text{Octet I}$  is the 16-codon group  $\text{Keto} \cap \text{Octet I}$ , whereas  $G_{\{A\}} \cap \text{Octet II}$  is the 8-codon group of Octet II with adenine at the third position. All 33 groups, together with their sizes, codon compositions, and Rumer-octet membership, are listed in the dataset `codon_groups.csv`.

In the group registry, the full set  $\mathcal{C}_{64}$  corresponds to the row with id 1. In this article, that group is denoted `All`, whereas  $\mathcal{C}_{64}$  denotes the codon set itself.

A direct consequence of the structure of the standard code is the *twin-group property*. Within every codon family, the codons NNC and NNT with identical first two positions encode the same amino acid. Therefore, exchanging  $C \leftrightarrow T$  at the third position does not change the multiset of encoded amino acids. Consequently, the Keto group {G, T} and the Strong group {C, G} have the same amino-acid composition, as do the Amino group {A, C} and the Weak group {A, T}. The two groups in each pair contain exactly the same service codons: Keto and Strong contain ATG and TAG, whereas Amino and Weak contain TAA and TGA. Therefore, under any assignment  $K$  that associates a pair of values  $(P, N)$  with each service codon (Section 2.4), the following identities hold for  $Q \in \{T, P, N, \Delta\}$ :

$$Q_K(\text{Keto}) = Q_K(\text{Strong}), \quad Q_K(\text{Amino}) = Q_K(\text{Weak}).$$

The same identities hold after intersecting each pair with Octet I or Octet II. We refer to these pairs of two-nucleotide groups as *twin groups*; in the dataset `codon_groups.csv`, the twin relationship is recorded in the column `Twin_Group_ID`.

A separate direct consequence of the same pyrimidine synonymy is the equality of the one-nucleotide groups {C} and {T} at the full-code level and after their intersection with either

octet. At the full-code level, each contains 16 codons; within either octet, each contains 8 codons. Because they do not arise by comparing two branches of a chemical axis, the term “twin groups” and the column `Twin_Group_ID` are not used for them in the present work. Both groups and their intersections with the octets contain no service codons; hence, both their values and the equalities between them are independent of parametrization.

## 2.4 Parametrization of service codons

The nucleon quantities of a codon group are obtained by summing the values of the amino acids encoded by its constituent codons in the standard genetic code. For codons counted only according to their amino-acid assignments, this summation is unambiguous. A separate convention is needed for the three stop codons, which have no amino-acid product, and for ATG in its initiator role; ATG also encodes methionine (Section 2.2).

The complete codon set  $\mathcal{C}_{64}$ , the four-codon service set  $\mathcal{S}$ , and the remaining 60-codon pool  $\mathcal{C}_{SE}$  are defined in Section 2.2. We refer to  $\mathcal{C}_{SE}$  below as the *service-excluded pool*; its technical identifier in the code and file names is `pool160`. Every codon in  $\mathcal{C}_{SE}$  is unambiguously assigned to a canonical amino acid. For  $c \in \mathcal{C}_{SE}$  and  $Q \in \{T, P, N, \Delta\}$ ,  $Q(c)$  denotes the corresponding quantity of the free neutral form of the amino acid encoded by  $c$ , as defined in Section 2.1.

For any codon set  $A \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{64}$  containing no service codons, define

$$Q(A) := \sum_{c \in A} Q(c).$$

For a codon group  $G$ , its sum over the service-excluded pool is defined by

$$Q_{SE}(G) := \sum_{c \in G \cap \mathcal{C}_{SE}} Q(c).$$

For a service codon  $c$ , the notation  $Q(c)$  without a key subscript is not used because the formal contribution of such a codon depends on the selected key. The subscript SE indicates a restriction of the summation domain, not a parametrization key. Neither the sum  $Q_{SE}(G)$  nor the number of codons included in it,  $|G \cap \mathcal{C}_{SE}|$ , depends on the assignments to the service codons.

If the group  $G$  itself contains no service codons, the restriction removes nothing and

$$Q(G) = Q_{SE}(G).$$

To analyze the complete 64-position table, we introduce a *parametric key*  $K$ : a fixed assignment of a pair of numbers  $(P_K(c), N_K(c))$  to every service codon  $c$ . Under such a key, the group sums are

$$(P_K(G), N_K(G)) = (P_{SE}(G), N_{SE}(G)) + \sum_{c \in G \cap \mathcal{S}} (P_K(c), N_K(c)),$$

and the remaining two quantities are derived rather than assigned independently:

$$T_K(G) = P_K(G) + N_K(G), \quad \Delta_K(G) = P_K(G) - N_K(G).$$

For  $Q \in \{T, P, N, \Delta\}$ ,  $Q_0(G)$  and  $Q_1(G)$  below denote the full group sums, including service-codon contributions, under the Key 0 and Key 1 assignments, respectively. The subscripts 0 and 1 label these two assignments; they are not numerical values of a scalar parameter. Thus  $Q_{SE}(G)$  is independent of the key, whereas  $Q_0(G)$  and  $Q_1(G)$  can differ only through the contributions of the service codons contained in group  $G$ . If group  $G$  contains no service codons, then  $Q_K(G) = Q(G) = Q_{SE}(G)$  for every  $K$ . The subscript SE applies only to codon groups; the subscripts  $K$ , 0, and 1 apply to full group sums and to the formal contributions of individual service codons. The two keys considered in this study are recorded in `key_parameters.csv`.



**The naive reading (Key 0).** Each of the three stop codons is assigned the zero contribution  $(P, N) = (0, 0)$  because a termination signal has no amino acid product. The ATG codon is treated as an ordinary methionine codon and receives the values of the free methionine molecule,  $(P, N) = (80, 69)$ . This simple convention corresponds to the ordinary reading of the amino-acid-coding part of the table, in which the stop signals are assigned a zero contribution, but it remains a parametrization. In particular, Key 0 is not identical to the service-excluded pool: Key 0 retains all 64 positions and counts ATG as methionine, whereas in the pool the summation runs over the remaining 60 codons only.

**Symmetrization (Key 1).** Each of the three stop codons is assigned  $(P, N) = (37, 37)$ , while ATG, treated as a formal initiation marker, is assigned  $(P, N) = (1, 0)$ . These values are not interpreted as the nucleon composition of physical translation products. They are derived in Sections 3.3–3.3.3 under the assumption that the three stop codons share a common parameter pair and under the conditions of balance and divisibility by 37 specified there. Under these assumptions, Key 1 is the unique minimal non-negative integer solution of the resulting system. Here Key 1 is introduced as the result of that formal construction, not as a biochemical property of termination signals or the initiator.

For codon groups containing no service codons, the values under Key 0 and Key 1 coincide with the direct amino-acid sums. If a group contains service codons, the Key 1 assignments have only a formal arithmetic meaning: the corresponding sums do not represent the nucleon composition of a physical ensemble of molecules. The terms “proton count”, “neutron count” and “total nucleon count” are retained for consistency with the underlying amino acid contributions, but no biochemical interpretation is claimed for the formal Key 1 contributions.

The dataset `key_parameters.csv` additionally contains eight reference assignments, Key 2–Key 9, considered during the exploratory stage. They are not used to obtain the results of this study and do not have the status of the derived Key 1. The following analysis therefore distinguishes three levels explicitly: the service-excluded pool, the naive reading (Key 0), and the symmetrization (Key 1).

## 2.5 Analytical criteria and classification of equalities

For each of the 33 codon groups defined in Section 2.3, we examine  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$ , and  $\Delta$  at three analytical levels: the service-excluded pool, Key 0, and Key 1. Three reporting procedures are described below: tests of divisibility by 37 and decimal roundness, and a search for exact equalities. Divisibility by 37 is the primary preselected arithmetic criterion. Exact powers, reduced ratios, and matches to amino acid differences are considered separately as additional descriptive observations. Statistical significance is assessed only where a corresponding null model is specified.

**Criterion 1: divisibility by 37.** For every group quantity  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$  and  $\Delta$ , we compute the quotient and remainder upon division by 37. A zero remainder denotes exact divisibility. This criterion continues the line of investigation opened by Shcherbak and Makukov [8] and developed by Panov and Filatov [5]. When a value is divisible by 37, its displayed factorization also exposes any further factors of the quotient; these are not assigned separate evidential weight without an additional analysis. Nonzero residues are reported descriptively only where they enter an exact relation between predefined groups.

Complete expressions of the form  $q \cdot 37 + r$  for all groups and all four quantities are provided in `pool60_divisibility-37.csv`, `key0_divisibility-37.csv` and `key1_divisibility-37.csv`.

**Criterion 2: roundness in the decimal system.** We call a positive integer quantity round in the decimal system if it is divisible by  $10^k$  for at least one integer  $k \geq 1$ ; its degree of roundness is

the largest such  $k$ . This criterion is used descriptively because the data contain exact multiples of 100 and 1000, notably among the parametrization-independent Octet I sums. Although roundness is tied to decimal notation, the divisibility being tested is a property of the integer itself:  $10^k \mid x$  is equivalent to simultaneous divisibility by  $2^k$  and  $5^k$ . The systematic control across prime moduli is presented in Section 4.2.

**Criterion 3: exact equalities.** At each analytical level, we compare the  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$ , and  $\Delta$  values of all 33 groups and record every exact match. Trivial identities such as  $P(G) = P(G)$  are not included in the results. Each equality is assigned to one of three classes:

- *different-size equalities* (DIFF\_PARAM in the Match\_Type column): the same numerical value is obtained by summing over different numbers of codons; either the same or different nucleon quantities may be compared;
- *same-size cross-quantity equalities* (CROSS\_PARAM): the groups contain the same number of codons, but different quantities are compared, for example  $P(G_1) = N(G_2)$ ;
- *same-size same-quantity equalities* (SAME\_PARAM): the groups contain the same number of codons and the same quantity is compared, for example  $P(G_1) = P(G_2)$ .

For classification, group size is the number of codons actually included in the sum. Under Key 0 and Key 1, this is the full size of the group in the 64-codon table. In the service-excluded pool, the service codons are removed, so groups containing them are smaller.

All identified equalities are listed in `pool60_equalities.csv`, `key0_equalities.csv` and `key1_equalities.csv`. Twin-group identities from Section 2.3 are also recorded, but are treated as consequences of identical amino acid composition rather than as new coincidences.

**Additional exploratory observations.** Beyond the primary procedures, we descriptively note:

- exact powers of small integers, for example  $4096 = 2^{12}$ ;
- reduced ratios within a group, including  $P/T$ ,  $N/T$ ,  $\Delta/T$ ,  $P/N$ ,  $\Delta/P$  and  $\Delta/N$ , tabulated in `pool60_ratios.csv`, `key0_ratios.csv` and `key1_ratios.csv`;
- matches between group-level quantities and the absolute differences  $|\delta P|$ ,  $|\delta N|$  or  $|\delta T|$  of individual amino acid pairs, such as  $|\delta N(\text{Trp}, \text{Ile})| = 37$ .

These observations describe the arithmetic and may provide a basis for testable hypotheses.

Finally, the four quantities are not independent:

$$T = P + N, \quad \Delta = P - N.$$

Equalities, divisibility relations or ratios obtained from one another through these identities are therefore not counted as separate evidence. The same applies to copies propagated through nested groups or twin-group identities. Section 3 distinguishes (i) facts computed directly for the service-excluded pool without assigning values to the service codons; (ii) identities whose invariance to the key is established algebraically; and (iii) results specific to Key 0 or Key 1.

## 2.6 Computed datasets and reproducibility

The principal deterministic results of this study are produced by `reproduce.py`. The script reads five input datasets and writes 17 computed output datasets. A separate deterministic script, `controls.py`, writes four control datasets, whereas the statistical analysis is performed by `mc_significance.py`, which writes the summary table `mc_significance.csv`, and is independently re-checked by `verify_mc.py`. By default, all data paths are resolved relative to the directory of the corresponding script.

**Input datasets.** Five input files define the numerical and structural basis of the analysis:

- `amino_acids_nucleons.csv` contains  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$  and  $\Delta$  for the twenty canonical amino acids (Section 2.1);
- `genetic_code_codons.csv` specifies the standard codon-to-translation-product mapping (Section 2.2);
- `ncbi_genetic_code_registry.csv` records a snapshot of the 27 NCBI translation tables, including the standard table (Section 2.2);
- `codon_groups.csv` defines the system of 33 overlapping codon groups (Section 2.3);
- `key_parameters.csv` contains the service-codon assignments of the parametric keys (Section 2.4).

**Per-key computed datasets.** For each of the two principal keys, Key 0 and Key 1, `reproduce.py` writes four files. The prefixes `key0_` and `key1_` identify the active key:

- `*_nucleon-data.csv` contains the four reported group quantities  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $T$  and  $\Delta$  for all 33 groups;  $T$  and  $\Delta$  are derived from  $P$  and  $N$ ;
- `*_divisibility-37.csv` expresses every quantity exactly as  $q \cdot 37 + r$ ;
- `*_equalities.csv` exhaustively enumerates exact numerical equalities and classifies them in the `Match_Type` column as `DIFF_PARAM`, `CROSS_PARAM` or `SAME_PARAM`, following Section 2.5;
- `*_ratios.csv` contains the six ratios  $P/T$ ,  $N/T$ ,  $\Delta/T$ ,  $P/N$ ,  $\Delta/P$  and  $\Delta/N$  both as exact reduced fractions and as rounded decimal approximations.

The two keys therefore produce eight output files.

**Service-excluded-pool datasets.** For the service-excluded pool, the script writes four analogous files: `pool60_nucleon-data.csv`, `pool60_divisibility-37.csv`, `pool60_equalities.csv` and `pool60_ratios.csv`. Before summation, the service codons are removed from every group  $G$ , so that the number of codons included is  $|G \cap \mathcal{C}_{SE}|$ . No parametric key is applied.

**Amino acid differences.** Three files written once, `amino_acids_proton_differences.csv`, `amino_acids_neutron_differences.csv` and `amino_acids_nucleon_differences.csv`, enumerate the absolute differences  $|\delta P|$ ,  $|\delta N|$  and  $|\delta T|$ , respectively, for all  $\binom{20}{2} = 190$  unordered pairs of canonical amino acids.

**Table-dependent NCBI pools.** The remaining two outputs of the core script compare the standard code with the other tables in `ncbi_genetic_code_registry.csv`. Because the sets of stop codons differ between tables, we do not assume in advance that every analyzed pool contains 60 codons. Two models are used. Model 1 excludes ATG and every codon listed in the `Stop_Codons` field. Model 2 excludes ATG and only the permanent stop codons marked `*` in the `Amino_Acids` field; context-dependent stops are included in the analysis with the amino acid assignments recorded for them. The models coincide for tables without context-dependent stops. For the standard table, both models give the same 60-codon service-excluded pool. The actual number of codons in the analyzed pool is recorded for both models (columns `Pure_Codons_Count` and `Pure_Codons_Count_Alt`).

`deficit_models_analysis.csv` contains one row for each of the 27 tables. The full proton and neutron sums follow the registered amino acid assignments, with positions marked `*` contributing zero. For both models, the file additionally records sums over the corresponding analyzed pool, the proton-sum residue modulo 37, and three neutron deficits relative to:

1. the constant 3700 obtained for standard-code Octet I;
2. structural  $T(\text{Octet I})$ , retaining the eight families that occupy Octet I positions in the standard table;
3. functional  $T(\text{Octet I})$ , selecting in table  $t$  those four-codon families that have one amino acid assignment and no permanent stop.

`keto_amino_balance_models.csv` uses the same two models and, for every table, sums  $P$  and  $N$  separately over the intersections of the analyzed pool with the third-position Keto and Amino groups. Both sums and the directed Keto-minus-Amino difference are recorded.

**Reproducibility of the core pipeline.** `reproduce.py` uses only the Python standard library and requires neither external packages nor a virtual environment. The computation is deterministic: outputs are written in UTF-8 with LF line endings and a fixed row order. The canonical repository files are regenerated from the five inputs without manual editing. All group sums and residues use integer arithmetic, while ratios are first reduced exactly by their greatest common divisor. The decimal columns in `*_ratios.csv` are rounded representations of exact fractions and are not used to obtain any result. Every deterministic numerical claim can be traced to a specific cell or to a documented exact combination of cells in the output files.

Neither `reproduce.py` nor `controls.py` uses randomization. Randomization is confined to the separate Monte Carlo analysis in `mc_significance.py`, with a fixed seed and a specified number of trials. Its tail-probability estimates and uncertainty intervals necessarily use floating-point values. `verify_mc.py` independently re-implements the same analysis; the statistical procedure is fully specified in Section 4.3.

**Supplementary visualizer.** `visualization.html` provides an interactive view of the translation tables and codon groups under the service-excluded pool (POOL60), Key 0 and Key 1, together with additional exploratory views. It is not part of the core reproducible pipeline and is not the source of published numerical results: values reported in the main text are checked against the deterministic CSV files. An online version is available at <https://ruslankhafizov.github.io/genetic-code-arithmetic/>.

**Supplementary control datasets.** `controls.py` reads the same five input files, uses only the Python standard library and writes four deterministic datasets:

- `position_axis_analysis.csv` separately applies the three binary chemical classifications Keto/Amino, Strong/Weak and Purine/Pyrimidine to the first, second and third codon positions at three analytical levels: the service-excluded pool, Key 0 and Key 1. For each side it records the four nucleon quantities and their residues modulo 37;
- `prime_divisibility_scan.csv` scans every prime up to 97 over three value sets: group quantities identical under Key 0 and Key 1, all Key 0 quantities, and all Key 1 quantities. For each prime it records the numbers of divisible instances, distinct nonzero values and distinct odd cores, together with a reference value  $n/p$  for  $n$  distinct values. This reference describes residue uniformity and is not a statistical null model or a  $p$ -value;
- `position_asymmetry_ncbi.csv` applies the Keto/Amino classification to each of the three positions of all 27 NCBI tables under Model 1 and Model 2. For  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$  and  $\Delta$ , it records directed Keto-minus-Amino differences, their residues modulo 37 and position-level summary flags;
- `representation_sensitivity.csv` recomputes 13 explicitly listed absolute and difference quantities under three representations of the encoded amino acid. Relative to the neutral

free molecule, the proton and neutron offsets are (0, 0) for the free molecule itself, (−10, −8) for the peptide residue, and (0, 0) for the zwitterion. For every quantity, the file records the result under each representation and its agreement with the free-molecule baseline.

These four files define the positional, modular, cross-table and representation-specificity controls. Their results are interpreted in Section 4.2.

**Data and code availability.** The accompanying repository contains the manuscript sources, five input datasets, 17 core computed datasets, four control datasets, the Monte Carlo summary table `mc_significance.csv`, four Python scripts and the interactive visualizer. Complete run commands and descriptions of the dataset columns are provided in the repository README: <https://github.com/RuslanKhafizov/genetic-code-arithmetic>. Versions of the materials are archived at Zenodo under the concept DOI 10.5281/zenodo.20360037.

### 3 Results

The arithmetic properties are considered here at three analytical levels. The first level (Section 3.1) comprises facts established without assigning values to the service codons. These facts constitute the central result of this work.

The second level (Section 3.2) is the naive reading (Key 0), in which the three stop codons are assigned a contribution of zero and the initiator ATG is counted as methionine.

The third level (Sections 3.3–3.4) introduces Key 1, the unique minimal non-negative integer assignment to the service codons, derived analytically from the joint conditions of Keto/Amino nucleon-pool balance and divisibility of the global pools by 37. This assignment extends the structure to the complete 64-codon table and serves as a formal device for exhibiting its arithmetic.

Section 3.5 draws together the findings of all three levels.

The standard code remains the principal object of analysis throughout. Alternative NCBI translation tables are examined later for comparison and to assess the specificity of the results.

#### 3.1 Parametrization-independent results

Parametrization-independence arises here for three distinct reasons. The first is built into the definition of the service-excluded pool: the sums run only over the sixty codons remaining after the service codons are excluded (Section 3.1.1). The second is that Octet I with all its sub-groups, and the groups restricted to pyrimidines in the third position, contain no service codons. The third concerns twin pairs of groups: both members of each pair contain the same service codons, so the equality between them is preserved under any values assigned to those codons.

The derivation of Key 1 uses the following results from this subsection: the neutron sum of the pool is a multiple of 37, while the proton sum is one unit below the nearest multiple of 37 (Section 3.1.1); the Keto/Amino asymmetry localizes in the Trp-Ile pair; and the proton count of every canonical amino acid is even (Section 3.1.5).

Figure 2 presents all 33 groups across the three levels of the hierarchy; for each group, the sums include only its non-service codons.

##### 3.1.1 The service-excluded pool: neutron divisibility and the proton residue

For the service-codon-excluded 60-codon pool  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$ —the complete 64-codon table excluding the three stop codons and the initiator ATG—the four nucleon quantities are

$$\begin{aligned} T(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) &= 7769, & P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) &= 4180, \\ N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) &= 3589, & \Delta(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) &= 591. \end{aligned}$$

Of the four quantities, only the neutron sum is exactly divisible by 37:

$$N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 97 \cdot 37.$$

The other three lie one unit below the nearest multiple of 37:

$$T(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 210 \cdot 37 - 1, \quad P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 113 \cdot 37 - 1,$$

$$\Delta(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 16 \cdot 37 - 1.$$

Because  $N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}})$  is divisible by 37, the relations  $T = P + N$  and  $\Delta = P - N$  imply  $T \equiv \Delta \equiv P \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$ ; thus, among these three residues, only the proton residue is an independent fact.

The Rumer partition of  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$  shows how this divisibility is distributed between the two octet contributions. Octet I lies entirely within  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$ , whereas the intersection of Octet II with  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$  contains 28 codons, since all four service codons belong to Octet II. The neutron sums are

$$\begin{aligned} N(\text{Octet I}) &= 1700 = 46 \cdot 37 - 2, \\ N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Octet II}) &= 1889 = 51 \cdot 37 + 2. \end{aligned}$$

Neither is a multiple of 37 on its own. Because these two parts form a partition of  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$ , their residues  $-2$  and  $+2$  cancel in the total sum:

$$N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 1700 + 1889 = 3589 = 97 \cdot 37.$$

The remaining Octet I quantities and their scaling across its sub-groups are considered below.

Partitioning the pool into the two 30-codon halves of the Keto/Amino axis gives a different pattern:

$$\begin{aligned} N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) &= 1813 = 49 \cdot 37, \\ N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) &= 1776 = 48 \cdot 37, \\ P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) &= 2108 = 57 \cdot 37 - 1, \\ P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) &= 2072 = 56 \cdot 37. \end{aligned}$$

Under the Keto/Amino partition, the divisibility is distributed differently: both neutron sums are divisible by 37 on their own, and no cancellation of residues is involved. At this level, the proton residue  $-1$  is carried by the Keto half, whereas the proton sum of the Amino half is divisible by 37. Accordingly,

$$\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) = 295 = 8 \cdot 37 - 1, \quad \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 296 = 8 \cdot 37.$$

The Strong/Weak axis reproduces the same values because of the twin-group identities (Section 3.1.3). On the Purine/Pyrimidine axis, all four service codons lie in the Purine half; after their exclusion,  $\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}$  is partitioned into a 28-codon Purine group and a 32-codon Pyrimidine group. Unlike the Keto/Amino axis, none of the quantities  $T$ ,  $P$ , and  $N$  is divisible by 37 for either of these groups. For  $\Delta$ , a one-unit difference remains:

$$\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Purine}) = 295 = 8 \cdot 37 - 1, \quad \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Pyrimidine}) = 296 = 8 \cdot 37.$$

The common source of the one-unit difference along the three chemical axes is visible at the level of the one-nucleotide groups:

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{\text{G}\}) &= 147 = 4 \cdot 37 - 1, \\ \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{\text{A}\}) &= \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{\text{C}\}) = \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{\text{T}\}) = 148 = 4 \cdot 37. \end{aligned}$$

The equality at 148 is not explained by equal group sizes: the  $\{\text{A}\}$  group contains 14 counted codons, whereas the  $\{\text{C}\}$  and  $\{\text{T}\}$  groups contain 16 each.



Partitioning by octet localizes the one-unit difference to Octet II. In Octet I, all four one-nucleotide sub-groups have  $\Delta = 75$ . Within Octet II,

$$\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{G\} \cap \text{Octet II}) = 72,$$

$$\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{A\} \cap \text{Octet II}) = \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{C\} \cap \text{Octet II}) = \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\{T\} \cap \text{Octet II}) = 73.$$

The groups  $\{A\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  and  $\{G\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  each contain six codons in the service-excluded pool, so the difference between 73 and 72 cannot be attributed to group size.

Thus, at the upper level of the three chemical axes, the residue  $-1$  in  $\Delta$  occurs in Keto, Strong, and Purine—the groups that admit G in the third position. The further reduction of the deviation within  $\{G\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  to the Trp–Ile pair is considered in Section 3.1.5.

### 3.1.2 Arithmetic of Octet I

Octet I (id 12) contains no service codons, so its nucleon quantities are independent of any parametrization:

$$T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700, \quad P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000,$$

$$N(\text{Octet I}) = 1700, \quad \Delta(\text{Octet I}) = 300.$$

All four values are multiples of 100, and  $P(\text{Octet I})$  is additionally a multiple of 1000. The total nucleon count satisfies

$$T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700 = 100 \cdot 37.$$

Octet I consists of eight fully four-fold degenerate codon families. Each of its six 16-codon sub-groups (ids 13–18) contains two codons of every family, so each of its nucleon quantities equals half the corresponding quantity of the whole octet:

$$T = 1850, \quad P = 1000, \quad N = 850, \quad \Delta = 150.$$

Each of the four 8-codon sub-groups (ids 19–22) contains one codon of every family and carries a quarter of the octet totals:

$$T = 925, \quad P = 500, \quad N = 425, \quad \Delta = 75.$$

Because the factor 100 in  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 100 \cdot 37$  is divisible by 4, divisibility of  $T$  by 37 survives at both sub-group levels:

$$3700 = 100 \cdot 37, \quad 1850 = 50 \cdot 37, \quad 925 = 25 \cdot 37.$$

The proton and neutron sums of the whole octet have opposite residues modulo 37:

$$P(\text{Octet I}) = 54 \cdot 37 + 2, \quad N(\text{Octet I}) = 46 \cdot 37 - 2,$$

which cancel in  $T = P + N$ . The same neutron residue  $-2$  is offset by the residue  $+2$  carried by Octet II in the service-excluded pool when the total neutron sum of that pool is formed (Section 3.1.1). At the 16-codon level, exact halving gives

$$P = 27 \cdot 37 + 1, \quad N = 23 \cdot 37 - 1.$$

For  $\Delta$ , the same scaling gives at the 8-codon level

$$\Delta = 75 = 2 \cdot 37 + 1.$$

The pyrimidine sub-group of Octet I,  $\{C, T\} \cap \text{Octet I}$  (id 18), and its 8-codon halves (id 19 and id 21) reappear in the pyrimidine cascade of Section 3.1.4.

The residues of  $N$  and  $\Delta$  follow algebraically from those of  $T$  and  $P$  through  $N = T - P$  and  $\Delta = P - N$ , and the sub-group values follow by exact scaling. The same scaling preserves the ratios

$$\frac{P}{T} = \frac{20}{37}, \quad \frac{N}{T} = \frac{17}{37}, \quad \frac{\Delta}{T} = \frac{3}{37}$$

at all three levels of the Octet I hierarchy.

|                       |                                              |                                                |                        |                                                                      |        |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| ALL: {C, G, A, T}     |                                              | T: 7769<br>P: 4180<br>N: 3589 /37=97<br>Δ: 591 |                        | 60                                                                   |        |
| Keto: {G, T}          |                                              | 30                                             | Amino: {A, C}          | T: 3848 /37=104<br>P: 2072 /37=56<br>N: 1776 /111=16<br>Δ: 296 /37=8 | 30     |
| Purine: {A, G}        |                                              | 28                                             | Pyrimidine: {C, T}     | T: 4096<br>P: 2196<br>N: 1900<br>Δ: 296 /37=8                        | 32     |
| {C}                   | T: 2048<br>P: 1098<br>N: 950<br>Δ: 148 /37=4 | 16                                             | {G}                    | T: 1873<br>P: 1010<br>N: 863<br>Δ: 147                               | 14     |
| {T}                   | T: 2048<br>P: 1098<br>N: 950<br>Δ: 148 /37=4 | 16                                             | {A}                    | T: 1800<br>P: 974<br>N: 826<br>Δ: 148 /37=4                          | 14     |
| Octet I: {C, G, A, T} |                                              | 32                                             | Octet II: {C, G, A, T} |                                                                      | 28     |
| {G, T}                |                                              | 16                                             | {G, T}                 | T: 2071<br>P: 1108<br>N: 963<br>Δ: 145                               | 14     |
| {A, C}                |                                              | 16                                             | {A, C}                 | T: 1998 /999=2<br>P: 1072<br>N: 926<br>Δ: 146                        | 14     |
| {C, G}                |                                              | 13, 14                                         | {C, G}                 |                                                                      | 24, 25 |
| {A, G}                |                                              | 16                                             | {A, G}                 |                                                                      | 12     |
| {C, T}                |                                              | 16                                             | {C, T}                 |                                                                      | 16     |
| {G, T}                |                                              | 17                                             | {G, T}                 |                                                                      | 28     |
| {A, C}                |                                              | 18                                             | {A, C}                 |                                                                      | 29     |
| {C, G}                |                                              | 19                                             | {C, G}                 |                                                                      | 30     |
| {A, T}                |                                              | 20                                             | {A, T}                 |                                                                      | 31     |
| {C}                   |                                              | 8                                              | {C}                    |                                                                      | 8      |
| {G}                   |                                              | 8                                              | {G}                    |                                                                      | 8      |
| {T}                   |                                              | 8                                              | {T}                    |                                                                      | 8      |
| {A}                   |                                              | 8                                              | {A}                    |                                                                      | 8      |

Figure 2: Structure of the service-excluded 60-codon pool  $\mathcal{C}_{SE}$  (pool160). Each group is summed only over its non-service codons; the three stop codons and the initiator ATG are excluded, so every quantity shown is independent of parametrization. Four quantities are given for each group: the total nucleon count  $T$ , proton sum  $P$ , neutron sum  $N$ , and hydrogen count  $\Delta = P - N$ . Cell layout: the group name appears in the upper-left corner, the number of codons remaining in the group in the upper-right corner, and the identifier from `codon_groups.csv` in the lower-right corner; pairs of twin groups with identical values are collapsed into a single cell, with the second name in the lower-left corner and both identifiers listed, separated by a comma, in the lower-right corner. Green, blue, and purple highlights indicate divisibility by 37,  $111 = 3 \cdot 37$ , and  $999 = 27 \cdot 37$ , respectively; the largest applicable modulus is marked. Figures 3 and 4 use the same grid and color code, but represent the complete 64-codon table. All three figures were generated by the `visualization.html` script.

### 3.1.3 Pyrimidine synonymy and twin-group identities

In the standard genetic code, the codons NNC and NNT (where C and T are pyrimidine bases) encode the same amino acid.

A direct algebraic consequence of pyrimidine synonymy is the equality of nucleon quantities between the groups **Keto** {G, T} (id 2) and **Strong** {C, G} (id 3), and between **Amino** {A, C} (id 4) and **Weak** {A, T} (id 5). Each of these four groups contains 32 codons. The distribution of service codons across them is uneven: Keto and Strong contain the stop codon TAG and the initiator ATG, while Amino and Weak contain two stop codons, TAA and TGA, and no start codon. Each of the four groups therefore has an intersection of 30 codons with  $\mathcal{C}_{SE}$ . Although these groups themselves contain service codons — so their individual full-group nucleon values depend on the assignment to those codons — the service codons enter both members of each twin pair symmetrically, and the equality of nucleon quantities holds under any such assignment.

Analogous equalities hold between  $\text{Keto} \cap \text{Octet II}$  and  $\text{Strong} \cap \text{Octet II}$  (id 24 and id 25), between  $\text{Amino} \cap \text{Octet II}$  and  $\text{Weak} \cap \text{Octet II}$  (id 26 and id 27), and between the corresponding pairs within Octet I (id 13 and id 14, id 15 and id 16). All these twin pairs are recorded in the `Twin_Group_ID` column of `codon_groups.csv`. Within Octet I, full four-fold degeneracy forces all six 16-codon sub-groups to be mathematically identical, but only the Keto/Strong and Amino/Weak pairs are recorded in `Twin_Group_ID`. The Purine/Pyrimidine pair is excluded because outside Octet I the two groups have substantially different amino acid composition: Purine contains all four service codons, while Pyrimidine contains none. Their equality within Octet I is a degeneracy-specific artifact, not a manifestation of pyrimidine synonymy.

A separate phenomenon of the same origin is the equality of the single-nucleotide groups {C} (id 8) and {T} (id 10), together with their intersections with each octet. This equality is qualitatively different: it does not relate groups across a chemical axis of partitioning, but follows directly from pyrimidine synonymy itself — a codon with C at the third position and the same codon with T encode the same amino acid by definition. For this reason the single-nucleotide pairs {C}/{T} are not recorded in `Twin_Group_ID`, which is reserved for pairs whose identical amino acid composition arises from pyrimidine synonymy across a two-nucleotide chemical axis (Keto/Strong or Amino/Weak). {C} and {T} form the only such pair in the standard code that is entirely free of service codons, and is therefore parametrization-independent both in its values and in their equality.

### 3.1.4 Arithmetic of pyrimidine-restricted groups

The Pyrimidine group (id 7) and its sub-groups form the second class of parametrization-independent groups of the standard code. Unlike Octet I, these groups span both octets and contain partially degenerate codon families; their arithmetic is therefore not inherited from a single set of values and must be examined separately at each level.

**The full pyrimidine group (id 7).** The nucleon quantities are

$$T = 4096, \quad P = 2196, \quad N = 1900, \quad \Delta = 296.$$

Three of these four values simultaneously satisfy distinct criteria:  $T = 4096 = 2^{12}$  is an exact power of two;  $N = 1900$  is an exact multiple of 100; and  $\Delta = 296 = 8 \cdot 37$  is divisible by 37.

**At the 16-codon level,** the groups {C} (id 8) and {T} (id 10) partition Pyrimidine into two identical halves with values  $T = 2048 = 2^{11}$ ,  $P = 1098$ ,  $N = 950$ , and  $\Delta = 148 = 4 \cdot 37$ .

**Pyrimidine-restricted groups at the 8-codon level.** Intersecting {C} and {T} with each octet yields four groups of 8 codons whose  $\Delta$  values, under any parametric key, are

$$\Delta = 75 = 2 \cdot 37 + 1 \quad \text{for } \{C\} \cap \text{Octet I (id 19) and } \{T\} \cap \text{Octet I (id 21),}$$

$$\Delta = 73 = 2 \cdot 37 - 1 \quad \text{for } \{C\} \cap \text{Octet II (id 30)} \text{ and } \{T\} \cap \text{Octet II (id 32)}.$$

These four values exhibit a systematic  $\pm 1$  deviation from a multiple of 37: the Octet I values lie one unit above  $74 = 2 \cdot 37$ , while the Octet II values lie one unit below. Adding the two 8-codon halves  $\{C\}$  and  $\{T\}$  within each octet recovers the intersections of the full pyrimidine group with the corresponding octet:

$$\Delta(\text{Pyrimidine} \cap \text{Octet I}) = 150 = 4 \cdot 37 + 2 \quad (\text{id 18}),$$

$$\Delta(\text{Pyrimidine} \cap \text{Octet II}) = 146 = 4 \cdot 37 - 2 \quad (\text{id 29}).$$

The  $\pm 1$  deviations at the 8-codon level double to  $\pm 2$  at the 16-codon level within each octet. Adding across both octets recovers  $\Delta(\text{Pyrimidine}) = 296 = 8 \cdot 37$ , with the deviations of opposite sign cancelling exactly. The resulting cascade  $\pm 1 \rightarrow \pm 2 \rightarrow 0$  — a systematic small deviation at the 8-codon level that doubles upon intra-octet combination and cancels upon inter-octet combination — extends to further groups under Key 0 (Section 3.2), where analogous one-unit deviations also appear in the proton and neutron residues.

### 3.1.5 Localization of the Keto/Amino asymmetry, and proton parity

Over the sense pool—parametrization-independent by construction—the differences between the Keto and Amino nucleon sums are

$$T_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - T_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 3921 - 3848 = 73,$$

$$P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 2108 - 2072 = 36,$$

$$N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 1813 - 1776 = 37,$$

$$\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 295 - 296 = -1,$$

These differences reduce to the nucleon counts of a single pair of molecules, and the reduction is structural.

**Reduction to a single pair.** Of the 16 codon families, 13 contain no service codon, and in each the codons NNG (Keto branch) and NNA (Amino branch) encode the same amino acid, contributing equally to both sums. The family TA also contributes equally: its pyrimidine pair TAC/TAT encodes Tyr in both branches, and its purine pair TAG/TAA consists of two stop codons, one in each branch, excluded from the sense pool. Asymmetry is realized only in the families AT (with ATA = Ile in the Amino branch; the Keto codon ATG is the excluded initiator) and TG (with TGG = Trp in the Keto branch; the Amino codon TGA is an excluded stop). In TG, Cys is present symmetrically and does not contribute; in AT, the remaining Ile codons ATT and ATC are likewise symmetric. The sense-pool asymmetry therefore reduces to the differences of the pair Trp–Ile, that is  $(73, 36, 37, -1)$ . This localization holds for any assignment giving equal values to the three stop codons and depends only on the code’s synonymy structure. (Under the naive reading, Key 0, the same asymmetry appears over the full code with the initiator’s product included,  $T(\text{Keto}) - T(\text{Amino}) = 222 = T(\text{Trp}) + T(\text{Met}) - T(\text{Ile})$ .)

**The pair and the modulus.** The two nucleon differences that matter for what follows are  $|\delta N(\text{Trp}, \text{Ile})| = 37$ , equal to the modulus, and  $|\delta P(\text{Trp}, \text{Ile})| = 36$ , one unit below it. Among the 190 pairs of canonical amino acids,  $|\delta N| = 37$  is realized only by Trp–Ile and Trp–Leu, and  $|\delta P| = 36$  only by the same two; Leu gives the same values as Ile because the two are isomers with identical counts  $P = 72$ ,  $N = 59$ , so a single nucleon profile is involved. The proton value follows from the neutron value and the hydrogen difference,  $\delta P = \delta N - (\Delta_{\text{Ile}} - \Delta_{\text{Trp}}) = 37 - 1 = 36$ , one below because isoleucine carries one more hydrogen than tryptophan.

These differences are properties of the two molecules alone and carry no independent statistical weight: the neutron difference coincides with the modulus at roughly the rate expected by

chance among amino-acid pairs. They enter the derivation of Section 3.3 as the offsets that the service-codon balance must reproduce, not as evidence in themselves; the atypicality of the arithmetic resides in the aggregate (Section 4.3), not in this pair. The induced total difference  $|\delta T| = |\delta P| + |\delta N| = 73 = 2 \cdot 37 - 1$  is not independent. Full distributions of  $|\delta N|$ ,  $|\delta P|$ , and  $|\delta T|$  over the 190 pairs are given in `amino_acids_neutron_differences.csv`, `amino_acids_proton_differences.csv`, and `amino_acids_nucleon_differences.csv`.

**Proton parity.** That  $|\delta P|$  is even—so that it cannot equal the odd value 37 and sits at 36 rather than on the modulus—reflects a general parity constraint on the proton counts. Every one of the 20 canonical amino acids has an even proton count: each value of  $P$  in `amino_acids_nucleons.csv` is even. The reason is electronic. In their neutral ground states the canonical amino acids are closed-shell molecules and therefore contain an even number of electrons; since a neutral molecule has equal numbers of electrons and protons, its proton count is even. Consequently every proton sum or pairwise difference over the amino acids is even, and no such quantity can equal an odd multiple of 37. This is the constraint behind the one-unit proton deficit of the sense pool (Section 3.1.1) and behind  $|\delta P| = 36$  here; parity fixes that these quantities miss the odd multiples of 37, while the size of the miss—one unit in both cases—is a property of the specific nucleon counts.

## 3.2 Results under the zero parametrization

Key 0 is the naive reading of the code: the three stop codons, which have no translation product, are assigned no nucleons, and the initiator ATG is counted as its product methionine. It introduces no derived parameters. We call it naive rather than physical because assigning zero to the stop codons is itself an assignment of values, not the absence of one; the genuinely assignment-free level is the sense pool of Section 3.1, over which the service codons are not summed at all. The properties below show that much of the arithmetic structure is already present at this reading, before the minimal parametrization of Section 3.3 is introduced—indeed the concentration on the lattice of step 37 is already atypical here (statistic S4a of Section 4.3). This bears on how the derived parametrization should be read: the structure is not created by assigning values to the service codons, only sharpened by it. Figure 3 gives a graphical overview of the quantities computed under Key 0 that are discussed below.

### 3.2.1 Divisibility of $T$ by 37 at the upper levels of partitioning

Under Key 0, the total nucleon count  $T$  is divisible by 37 for the four 32-codon groups along the chemical axes Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak:

$$T(\text{Keto}) = T(\text{Strong}) = 4070 = 110 \cdot 37 \quad (\text{id 2 and id 3});$$

$$T(\text{Amino}) = T(\text{Weak}) = 3848 = 104 \cdot 37 \quad (\text{id 4 and id 5}).$$

Divisibility of  $T$  by 37 extends also to Octet II and its 16-codon sub-groups:

$$T(\text{Octet II}) = 4218 = 114 \cdot 37 \quad (\text{id 23});$$

$$T(\text{Keto} \cap \text{Octet II}) = T(\text{Strong} \cap \text{Octet II}) = 2220 = 60 \cdot 37 \quad (\text{id 24 and id 25});$$

$$T(\text{Amino} \cap \text{Octet II}) = T(\text{Weak} \cap \text{Octet II}) = 1998 = 54 \cdot 37 \quad (\text{id 26 and id 27}).$$

Combined with  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700 = 100 \cdot 37$  from Section 3.1.2, this gives divisibility by 37 for the total nucleon count of the full code:  $T(\text{All}) = 7918 = 214 \cdot 37$  (id 1).

The divisibilities  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700$ ,  $T(\text{Octet II}) = 4218$ , and  $T(\text{Keto} \cap \text{Octet II}) = T(\text{Strong} \cap \text{Octet II}) = 2220$  by 37 correspond, within our partitioning, to results established by Shcherbak and Makukov [8] and Panov and Filatov [5] (see Section 4.4 for further discussion); the remaining divisibilities of  $T$  by 37 given in this subsection follow algebraically from those of these groups. The numerical values of all group quantities under Key 0 are tabulated in `key0_nucleon-data.csv`.

|                                                                                                                             |    |        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|--------|
| <b>ALL: {C, G, A, T}</b><br>T: <b>7918</b> /37=214<br>P: <b>4260</b><br>N: <b>3658</b><br>Δ: <b>602</b>                     |    | 64     |
| <b>Keto: {G, T}</b><br>T: <b>4070</b> /37=110<br>P: <b>2188</b><br>N: <b>1882</b><br>Δ: <b>306</b><br><b>Strong: {C, G}</b> | 32 | 1      |
| <b>Amino: {A, C}</b><br>T: <b>3848</b> /37=104<br>P: <b>2072</b> /37=56<br>N: <b>1776</b> /111=16<br><b>Weak: {A, T}</b>    | 32 | 4, 5   |
| <b>Purine: {A, G}</b><br>T: <b>3822</b><br>P: <b>2064</b><br>N: <b>1758</b><br>Δ: <b>306</b>                                | 32 | 6      |
| <b>Pyrimidine: {C, T}</b><br>T: <b>4096</b><br>P: <b>2196</b><br>N: <b>1900</b><br>Δ: <b>296</b> /37=8                      | 32 | 7      |
| <b>{C}</b><br>T: <b>2048</b><br>P: <b>1098</b><br>N: <b>950</b><br>Δ: <b>148</b> /37=4                                      | 16 | 8      |
| <b>{G}</b><br>T: <b>2022</b><br>P: <b>1090</b><br>N: <b>932</b><br>Δ: <b>158</b>                                            | 16 | 9      |
| <b>{T}</b><br>T: <b>2048</b><br>P: <b>1098</b><br>N: <b>950</b><br>Δ: <b>148</b> /37=4                                      | 16 | 10     |
| <b>{A}</b><br>T: <b>1800</b><br>P: <b>974</b><br>N: <b>826</b><br>Δ: <b>148</b> /37=4                                       | 16 | 11     |
| <b>Octet I: {C, G, A, T}</b><br>T: <b>3700</b> /37=100<br>P: <b>2000</b><br>N: <b>1700</b><br>Δ: <b>300</b>                 |    | 32     |
| <b>{G, T}</b><br>T: <b>1850</b> /37=50<br>P: <b>1000</b><br>N: <b>850</b><br>Δ: <b>150</b><br><b>{C, G}</b>                 | 16 | 12     |
| <b>{A, C}</b><br>T: <b>1850</b> /37=50<br>P: <b>1000</b><br>N: <b>850</b><br>Δ: <b>150</b><br><b>{A, T}</b>                 | 16 | 13, 14 |
| <b>{A, G}</b><br>T: <b>1850</b> /37=50<br>P: <b>1000</b><br>N: <b>850</b><br>Δ: <b>150</b>                                  | 16 | 15, 16 |
| <b>{C, T}</b><br>T: <b>1850</b> /37=50<br>P: <b>1000</b><br>N: <b>850</b><br>Δ: <b>150</b>                                  | 16 | 17     |
| <b>{C}</b><br>T: <b>925</b> /37=25<br>P: <b>500</b><br>N: <b>425</b><br>Δ: <b>75</b>                                        | 8  | 18     |
| <b>{G}</b><br>T: <b>925</b> /37=25<br>P: <b>500</b><br>N: <b>425</b><br>Δ: <b>75</b>                                        | 8  | 19     |
| <b>{T}</b><br>T: <b>925</b> /37=25<br>P: <b>500</b><br>N: <b>425</b><br>Δ: <b>75</b>                                        | 8  | 20     |
| <b>{A}</b><br>T: <b>925</b> /37=25<br>P: <b>500</b><br>N: <b>425</b><br>Δ: <b>75</b>                                        | 8  | 21     |
| <b>Octet II: {C, G, A, T}</b><br>T: <b>4218</b> /111=38<br>P: <b>2260</b><br>N: <b>1958</b><br>Δ: <b>302</b>                |    | 32     |
| <b>{G, T}</b><br>T: <b>2220</b> /111=20<br>P: <b>1188</b><br>N: <b>1032</b><br>Δ: <b>156</b><br><b>{C, G}</b>               | 16 | 22     |
| <b>{A, C}</b><br>T: <b>1998</b> /999=2<br>P: <b>1072</b><br>N: <b>926</b><br>Δ: <b>146</b><br><b>{A, T}</b>                 | 16 | 23     |
| <b>{A, G}</b><br>T: <b>1972</b><br>P: <b>1064</b><br>N: <b>908</b><br>Δ: <b>156</b>                                         | 16 | 24, 25 |
| <b>{C, T}</b><br>T: <b>2246</b><br>P: <b>1196</b><br>N: <b>1050</b><br>Δ: <b>146</b>                                        | 16 | 26, 27 |
| <b>{C}</b><br>T: <b>1123</b><br>P: <b>598</b><br>N: <b>525</b><br>Δ: <b>73</b>                                              | 8  | 28     |
| <b>{G}</b><br>T: <b>1097</b><br>P: <b>590</b><br>N: <b>507</b><br>Δ: <b>83</b>                                              | 8  | 29     |
| <b>{T}</b><br>T: <b>1123</b><br>P: <b>598</b><br>N: <b>525</b><br>Δ: <b>73</b>                                              | 8  | 30     |
| <b>{A}</b><br>T: <b>875</b><br>P: <b>474</b><br>N: <b>401</b><br>Δ: <b>73</b>                                               | 8  | 31     |
| <b>{C}</b><br>T: <b>1123</b><br>P: <b>598</b><br>N: <b>525</b><br>Δ: <b>73</b>                                              | 8  | 32     |
| <b>{G}</b><br>T: <b>1097</b><br>P: <b>590</b><br>N: <b>507</b><br>Δ: <b>83</b>                                              | 8  | 33     |

Figure 3: Nucleon parameters ( $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ ,  $\Delta$ ) of all codon groups under Key 0. For each cell: the group name is shown in the upper left; the group size (in codons) in the upper right; the group identifier from `codon_groups.csv` in the lower right. For twin-group pairs (Keto/Strong and Amino/Weak on the global code level, and their analogues within Octet I and Octet II), whose values are identical by pyrimidine synonymy, the display is collapsed into a single block: the second group name appears in the lower left, and the identifiers of both groups are listed, comma-separated, in the lower right. Green highlights indicate exact divisibility by 37; blue, by  $111 = 3 \cdot 37$ ; purple, by  $999 = 27 \cdot 37$ . Generated by the accompanying `visualization.html`.



### 3.2.2 Alignment of Amino and Weak with the lattice of step 37

Under Key 0, the groups Amino (id 4) and Weak (id 5) are the only 32-codon groups of the standard code in which all four nucleon quantities are simultaneously divisible by 37:

$$T = 3848 = 104 \cdot 37, \quad P = 2072 = 56 \cdot 37,$$

$$N = 1776 = 48 \cdot 37, \quad \Delta = 296 = 8 \cdot 37.$$

The only service codons in the Amino and Weak groups are stop codons, which contribute zero under Key 0; these sums therefore coincide with the sense-pool sums of the two groups, so the divisibility is in fact parametrization-independent, not specific to Key 0.

For these same groups, the ratios reduce to

$$\frac{P}{T} = \frac{7}{13}, \quad \frac{N}{T} = \frac{6}{13}, \quad \frac{\Delta}{T} = \frac{1}{13}.$$

### 3.2.3 The $\pm 1$ deviation pattern under Key 0

Under Key 0 the pyrimidine  $\Delta$ -cascade of Section 3.1.4 extends to further groups, and is joined by one-unit deviations of the same magnitude in the proton and neutron residues of groups in parallel positions of the codon hierarchy. The two are alike in form but distinct in the quantity affected.

**The 16-codon level.** The parametrization-independent condition  $P \equiv +1, N \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$  on the 16-codon sub-groups of Octet I (Section 3.1.2) is complemented, under Key 0, by the mirror condition on the 16-codon sub-groups of the Amino branch of Octet II —  $\{A, C\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  (id 26) and  $\{A, T\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  (id 27):

$$P \equiv -1 \pmod{37}, \quad N \equiv +1 \pmod{37},$$

with  $P = 1072 = 29 \cdot 37 - 1$  and  $N = 926 = 25 \cdot 37 + 1$ .

**The 8-codon level.** The parametrization-independent part of the pattern at this level is described in Section 3.1.4:  $\Delta = +1$  on the 8-codon sub-groups of Octet I,  $\Delta = -1$  on the pyrimidine-restricted 8-codon sub-groups of Octet II. Under Key 0,  $\{A\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  (id 33) joins the groups with  $\Delta = 73 = 2 \cdot 37 - 1$ , completing the mirror triple in Octet II. As a consequence, the parametrization-independent equality  $\Delta(\{C\}) = \Delta(\{T\}) = 148$  (Section 3.1.4) extends under Key 0 to a third single-nucleotide group at the full 64-codon level:  $\Delta(\{A\}) = 148$  (id 11). Under Key 0 the two stop codons of the Amino branch contribute  $\Delta = 0$ , so this full-code group and the 14-codon sense-pool group of the same name (Figure 2) share the value 148. The fourth single-nucleotide sub-group of Octet II,  $\{G\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  (id 31), gives  $\Delta = 83$  under Key 0 and is the only deviation from the pattern at this level; this group contains both the start codon ATG and the stop codon TAG.

## 3.3 Analytical derivation of Key 1

The parametrization-independent facts of Section 3.1, and their naive reading in Section 3.2, leave the service codons unassigned. There is a unique minimal integer assignment to those codons that extends the structure to the full 64-codon table, and this section derives it. The assignment is a device for exhibiting the arithmetic of the complete table rather than a foundation: as Section 3.2 shows, the structure is already present at the naive reading, and the derivation below only fixes the values under which it extends cleanly across the service codons.

The values are obtained from three inputs, all established earlier. The Keto/Amino asymmetry localizes in the single pair Trp-Ile, with sense-pool differences  $|\delta N| = 37$  and  $|\delta P| = 36$

(Section 3.1.5); the sense-pool neutron and proton totals are  $97 \cdot 37$  and  $\equiv -1 \pmod{37}$  (Section 3.1.1); and the proton counts are even, so  $|\delta P| = 37$  is excluded by parity (Section 3.1.5). From these, Sections 3.3.1 and 3.3.2 determine the stop and start parameters through symmetry conditions—first for neutrons, then for protons—and Section 3.3.3 shows that the solution is the minimal non-negative integer element of an infinite family, and that the equality of the stop parameters and the unit offset of the start parameter follow already from two of the chemical-axis balances, without reference to the modulus. The specificity of the result across natural codes is examined in Section 4.1.

### 3.3.1 Determination of neutron parameters

We seek a parametrization of the service codons under which the residual deviations described in Section 3.3 disappear. We denote the (yet unknown) parameters of the stop codons by  $(p_{\text{stop}}, n_{\text{stop}})$  and of the start codon by  $(p_{\text{start}}, n_{\text{start}})$ , with the convention that the three stop codons share the same parameters — a hypothesis already invoked in Section 3.1.5 when reducing the Keto/Amino asymmetry to the Trp-Ile pair. In this subsection we determine the neutron components  $n_{\text{stop}}$  and  $n_{\text{start}}$ . The proton components are determined in Section 3.3.2.

**Distribution of service codons.** All four service codons belong to Octet II; Octet I contains no service codon. Along the Keto/Amino axis, the start codon ATG and the stop codon TAG carry third-position G and belong to the Keto branch, while the stop codons TAA and TGA carry third-position A and belong to the Amino branch. Thus the Keto branch contains one stop and one start, and the Amino branch contains two stops and no start. The same distribution applies to the Strong and Weak branches respectively, by the Keto  $\equiv$  Strong and Amino  $\equiv$  Weak identities of Section 3.1.3.

**Balance equation for Keto and Amino.** The neutron pools of Keto and Amino, expressed through the sense pool values established in Section 3.1.5 and the unknown parameters of the service codons, are

$$\begin{aligned} N(\text{Keto}) &= 1813 + n_{\text{start}} + n_{\text{stop}}, \\ N(\text{Amino}) &= 1776 + 2 n_{\text{stop}}. \end{aligned}$$

Imposing the symmetry condition  $N(\text{Keto}) = N(\text{Amino})$  (the Purine/Pyrimidine axis cannot serve here, as its balance is incompatible with divisibility by 37; see Section 3.3.3) yields

$$n_{\text{stop}} - n_{\text{start}} = 37.$$

The right-hand side is the difference  $N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino})$  established in Section 3.1.5; its value is determined by the nucleon difference of the Trp-Ile pair. The condition is a one-parameter family of solutions in two unknowns; a second independent constraint is required to fix the parameters individually.

**Divisibility of the global neutron pool by 37.** The sense pool of all 60 sense codons carries  $N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 3589 = 97 \cdot 37$  (Section 3.1.1), an exact divisibility that is a property of the sense codons alone and independent of any service-codon parametrization. However, at the level of the entire genetic code, the inclusion of service codons disrupts this arithmetic alignment. Under Key 0, where the start codon is interpreted as Met, the global pool becomes  $N(\text{All}) = 3658 = 98 \cdot 37 + 32$ , which is not divisible by 37. We require the analytical parametrization to restore this underlying divisibility at the global scale:

$$N(\text{All}) = 3589 + n_{\text{start}} + 3 n_{\text{stop}} \equiv 0 \pmod{37},$$

which reduces to

$$n_{\text{start}} + 3 n_{\text{stop}} \equiv 0 \pmod{37}.$$

**Solution.** Substituting  $n_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{start}} + 37$  from the first condition into the second yields

$$4n_{\text{start}} + 111 \equiv 0 \pmod{37}.$$

Since  $111 = 3 \cdot 37 \equiv 0 \pmod{37}$  and  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$ , this reduces to

$$n_{\text{start}} \equiv 0 \pmod{37},$$

giving the family of integer solutions  $n_{\text{start}} = 0, 37, 74, \dots$ . The minimal non-negative integer solution is

$$n_{\text{start}} = 0, \quad n_{\text{stop}} = 37.$$

The structure of the solution family and the minimality of this choice are addressed in Section 3.3.3.

**Emergent cross-parameter equality.** Substitution of the obtained values into Octet II yields

$$N(\text{Octet II}) = 1889 + 0 + 3 \cdot 37 = 2000 = P(\text{Octet I}).$$

This cross-parameter equality between the neutron content of Octet II and the proton content of Octet I was not imposed during the derivation; it emerges as a consequence of the minimal non-negative integer solution to the two conditions imposed (Keto/Amino balance and global divisibility by 37).

**Non-triviality of the integer solution.** Three arithmetic facts combine in the derivation, and each is independent of the other two:

1. the difference  $N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 37$ , a property of the Trp-Ile pair (Section 3.1.5);
2. the divisibility of the global sense pool  $N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 3589 = 97 \cdot 37$  by 37, a chemical property of the standard code independent of any service-codon parametrization;
3. the existence of a minimal non-negative integer solution with both parameters small. The relative primality  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$ , where 4 is the coefficient of  $n_{\text{start}}$  in the combined equation and 37 is the modulus, ensures that the divisibility condition reduces to  $n_{\text{start}} \equiv 0 \pmod{37}$  rather than to a constraint admitting multiple small residues.

**Macroscopic consequences.** Under the values  $n_{\text{stop}} = 37$ ,  $n_{\text{start}} = 0$ , the neutron pools of the four 32-codon groups along the chemical axes satisfy

$$N(\text{Keto}) = N(\text{Amino}) = N(\text{Strong}) = N(\text{Weak}) = 1850 = \frac{1}{2} T(\text{Octet I}),$$

and the global identity

$$N(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700$$

holds. The neutron content of each chemical-axis half of the code coincides with exactly half of the  $T$ -invariant of Octet I, and the global neutron pool coincides with this  $T$ -invariant in full. The complete set of consequences is collected in Section 3.4.

### 3.3.2 Determination of proton parameters

Having determined the neutron components in Section 3.3.1, we now apply the same approach to determine the proton components  $p_{\text{stop}}$  and  $p_{\text{start}}$ . The convention that the three stop codons share the same parameters is preserved.

**Balance equation for Keto and Amino.** The proton pools of Keto and Amino, expressed through the sense pool values established in Section 3.1.5 and the unknown parameters of the service codons, are

$$\begin{aligned} P(\text{Keto}) &= 2108 + p_{\text{start}} + p_{\text{stop}}, \\ P(\text{Amino}) &= 2072 + 2p_{\text{stop}}. \end{aligned}$$

Imposing the corresponding condition  $P(\text{Keto}) = P(\text{Amino})$  (again on the Keto/Amino axis, for the reason noted above) yields

$$p_{\text{stop}} - p_{\text{start}} = 36.$$

The right-hand side is the difference  $P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino})$  established in Section 3.1.5; its value is 36 rather than 37, the parity-constrained value of  $|\delta P(\text{Trp, Ile})|$  (Section 3.1.5). The condition is a one-parameter family of solutions in two unknowns; a second independent constraint is required to fix the parameters individually.

**Divisibility of the global proton pool by 37.** The sense pool of all 60 sense codons of the standard code carries

$$P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = P(\text{Octet I}) + P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Octet II}) = 2000 + 2180 = 4180 = 113 \cdot 37 - 1.$$

Unlike the neutron pool, the global proton pool of the sense codons is not divisible by 37; it lies one proton below the nearest multiple,  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$ . We require the analytical parametrization of the service codons to close this deficit and bring the global proton pool onto the lattice of step 37:

$$P(\text{All}) = 4180 + p_{\text{start}} + 3p_{\text{stop}} \equiv 0 \pmod{37},$$

which reduces to

$$p_{\text{start}} + 3p_{\text{stop}} \equiv 1 \pmod{37}.$$

**Solution.** Substituting  $p_{\text{stop}} = p_{\text{start}} + 36$  from the first condition into the second yields

$$4p_{\text{start}} + 108 \equiv 1 \pmod{37}.$$

Since  $108 = 2 \cdot 37 + 34$  and  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$ , this reduces to

$$4p_{\text{start}} \equiv 4 \pmod{37}, \quad \text{hence} \quad p_{\text{start}} \equiv 1 \pmod{37},$$

giving the family of integer solutions  $p_{\text{start}} = 1, 38, 75, \dots$ . The minimal non-negative integer solution is

$$p_{\text{start}} = 1, \quad p_{\text{stop}} = 37.$$

The structure of the solution family and the minimality of this choice are addressed in Section 3.3.3.

**Emergent equality of stop parameters.** The neutron and proton parameters of the stop codons obtained independently in Sections 3.3.1 and 3.3.2 coincide:

$$p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}} = 37.$$

Each stop codon under Key 1 carries the same number of protons and neutrons, both equal to the organizing multiplier 37. This equality was not imposed; it follows from the minimal non-negative integer solutions to two formally independent systems — one in neutrons, one in protons — each constrained by Keto/Amino balance and global divisibility by 37.

**Non-triviality of the integer solution.** Three arithmetic facts combine in the derivation:

1. the difference  $P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Keto}) - P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Amino}) = 36$ , the parity-constrained value of  $|\delta P(\text{Trp, Ile})|$  (Section 3.1.5);
2. the residue  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$ , a deficit of one proton on the 37-lattice and a chemical property of the standard code independent of any service-codon parametrization;
3. the existence of a minimal non-negative integer solution with both parameters small. The relative primality  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$ , where 4 is the coefficient of  $p_{\text{start}}$  in the combined equation and 37 is the modulus, ensures that the divisibility condition reduces to  $p_{\text{start}} \equiv 1 \pmod{37}$  rather than to a constraint admitting multiple small residues.

Facts (1) and (2) share a common origin in the proton parity of the canonical amino acids: parity excludes odd values on the 37-lattice — both the value 37 for  $|\delta P|$  and an odd multiple for  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}})$  — forcing an unavoidable deviation from these target values. The particular values that this deviation takes (36 and  $-1$ ) are fixed by the nucleon composition of the code. The minimal solution  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$  closes exactly this single-proton deficit at the global scale.

**Macroscopic consequences.** Under the values  $p_{\text{stop}} = 37$ ,  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$ , the proton pools of the four 32-codon groups along the chemical axes satisfy

$$P(\text{Keto}) = P(\text{Amino}) = P(\text{Strong}) = P(\text{Weak}) = 2146 = \frac{1}{2} T(\text{Octet II}),$$

and the global identity

$$P(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet II}) = 4292$$

holds, with  $T(\text{Octet II})$  evaluated under Key 1. Unlike  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700$ , which is parametrization-independent and serves as a chemical invariant,  $T(\text{Octet II})$  depends on the values assigned to the service codons; under Key 1 it takes the value 4292. Together with the analogous neutron identities  $N(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700$  and  $N(\text{Keto}) = \frac{1}{2} T(\text{Octet I})$  established in Section 3.3.1, the parametrization realizes a dual matching: the global neutron pool aligns with  $T(\text{Octet I})$ , the global proton pool aligns with  $T(\text{Octet II})$ , and each chemical-axis half of the code coincides with exactly half of the corresponding octet's total nucleon content. The complete set of consequences is collected in Section 3.4.

### 3.3.3 Hierarchy of constraints and the choice of Key 1

The derivation in Sections 3.3.1 and 3.3.2 imposed two kinds of constraint on the service-codon parameters, each applied to neutrons and to protons: Keto/Amino balance and divisibility of the global pool by 37. Each constraint reduces the dimension of the solution space, and the family of admissible parametrizations narrows in three steps:

1. Keto/Amino balance alone, applied separately to neutrons and protons, gives a two-parameter family of solutions: the conditions  $n_{\text{stop}} - n_{\text{start}} = 37$  and  $p_{\text{stop}} - p_{\text{start}} = 36$  reduce the four service-codon parameters to two independent degrees of freedom, one for each nucleon quantity. All elements of this family align the four 32-codon groups along the chemical axes Keto / Amino / Strong / Weak.
2. Adding global divisibility of  $N(\text{All})$  by 37 further restricts the neutron parameters to the discrete one-parameter family  $n_{\text{start}} \in \{0, 37, 74, \dots\}$ , that is  $n_{\text{start}} = 37k$  for  $k \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ . Adding global divisibility of  $P(\text{All})$  by 37 similarly restricts the proton parameters to  $p_{\text{start}} \in \{1, 38, 75, \dots\}$ , that is  $p_{\text{start}} = 1 + 37m$  for  $m \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}$ . The combined family becomes a discrete two-dimensional lattice indexed by  $(k, m) \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 0}^2$  with step 37 in each direction.

3. Selecting the minimal non-negative integer element of this lattice ( $k = m = 0$ ) gives Key 1:  
 $(p_{\text{stop}}, n_{\text{stop}}) = (37, 37)$ ,  $(p_{\text{start}}, n_{\text{start}}) = (1, 0)$ .

The minimal element is distinguished from all other solutions by a combination of structural features that the constraints alone do not require: the value  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}} = 37$ , equal to the organizing multiplier of the code and attained only at the minimal element; the value  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$ , closing exactly the parity-induced deficit  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$  (Section 3.3.2); and the value  $n_{\text{start}} = 0$ , at which the start codon contributes no neutrons. Of these, only  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}} = 37$  singles out the minimal element on its own:  $n_{\text{start}} = 0$  holds for every element with  $k = 0$  and  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$  for every element with  $m = 0$ , and the two coincide with  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}} = 37$  only at  $k = m = 0$ . Higher elements of the lattice satisfy the same constraints but lack this combination. We adopt Key 1 as the parametrization of the standard genetic code throughout the remainder of the paper.

**The stop-parameter equality as a two-axis condition.** The equality  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}}$  and the offset  $p_{\text{start}} - n_{\text{start}} = 1$ , obtained in Section 3.3.3 from the minimal solution of the two modulo-37 systems, also follow from the two chemical-axis balances alone, with no reference to 37. Writing  $\Delta = P - N$ , the Keto/Amino balance ( $n_{\text{stop}} - n_{\text{start}} = 37$ ,  $p_{\text{stop}} - p_{\text{start}} = 36$ ) gives  $\Delta_{\text{start}} = \Delta_{\text{stop}} + 1$ . Since all four service codons lie in the Purine branch, equalizing the  $\Delta$ -invariant across the Purine/Pyrimidine axis requires the service increment to close the sense-pool deficit  $\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Pyrimidine}) - \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Purine}) = 1$ , that is  $\Delta_{\text{start}} + 3\Delta_{\text{stop}} = 1$ . The same purine localization of the service codons is also what forces the balance in  $P$  and  $N$  to be imposed on the Keto/Amino axis rather than on Purine/Pyrimidine: with all increments confined to the Purine branch, a Purine = Pyrimidine balance would require  $p_{\text{start}} + 3p_{\text{stop}} = 212$  and  $n_{\text{start}} + 3n_{\text{stop}} = 211$ , whereas global divisibility requires these same sums to be  $\equiv 1$  and  $\equiv 0 \pmod{37}$ ; since  $212 \equiv 27$  and  $211 \equiv 26$ , the two demands are incompatible, and among the third-position axes only a balance on Keto/Amino (equivalently, by the twin identity of Section 3.1.3, on Strong/Weak) is compatible with the 37-lattice. The obstruction is specific to  $P$  and  $N$ , whose service sums are large (212 and 211) and land at the wrong residues. For  $\Delta = P - N$  the situation differs: the Purine/Pyrimidine  $\Delta$ -deficit is only  $\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Pyrimidine}) - \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Purine}) = 1$ , small enough to be closed by the service increment, and it coincides with the offset  $\Delta_{\text{start}} - \Delta_{\text{stop}} = 1$  left by the Keto/Amino balance. The Keto/Amino  $P/N$  balance and the Purine/Pyrimidine  $\Delta$ -balance are therefore mutually compatible, which is what makes the two-axis condition available.

This fixes only the proton–neutron differences of the service codons, not their absolute values: the modulus 37 and the minimality condition remain necessary to obtain  $(37, 37)$  and  $(1, 0)$ . Its content is that the equality of the stop parameters is not tied to the modulus—it holds whenever the Keto/Amino and Purine/Pyrimidine  $\Delta$ -balances hold—and that it reduces to the agreement of two sense-pool unit offsets: the proton–neutron difference  $\delta P - \delta N = -1$  of the localizing pair (Section 3.1.5) and the branch deficit  $\Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Pyrimidine}) - \Delta_{\text{SE}}(\text{Purine}) = +1$ . The coincidence is thus relocated rather than removed, but it is shown to be a joint property of two chemical axes rather than an artifact of the parametrization.

**Convergence of independent routes.** The values of Key 1 are not tied to a single derivation. Three routes, resting on different structural inputs, reach the same assignment. The first is the modulo-37 system used above: the Keto/Amino balance together with divisibility of the global neutron and proton pools, whose minimal non-negative solution is  $(p_{\text{stop}}, n_{\text{stop}}) = (37, 37)$ ,  $(p_{\text{start}}, n_{\text{start}}) = (1, 0)$ . The second is the two-axis condition of Section 3.3.3: the Keto/Amino balance together with the  $\Delta$ -balance across the Purine/Pyrimidine axis forces  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}}$  and  $p_{\text{start}} = n_{\text{start}} + 1$  with no reference to the modulus. The third fixes the neutron parameters directly from the parametrization-independent half-octet target  $N(\text{Amino}) = N(\text{Keto}) = \frac{1}{2} T(\text{Octet I}) = 1850$ : the sense-pool deficits  $1850 - 1776 = 74 = 2 \cdot 37$  (closed by the two stop codons of the



Amino branch) and  $1850 - 1813 = 37$  (closed by the stop and start of the Keto branch) give  $n_{\text{stop}} = 37$  and  $n_{\text{start}} = 0$ .

### 3.4 Consequences under Key 1

In this section we describe the arithmetic structure of the standard genetic code under Key 1: alignment of the 32-codon chemical-axis groups, identities between the global nucleon pools and the structural totals of the octets, higher-order divisibility properties, the  $\Delta$ -invariant across all six 32-codon groups, and the Purine/Pyrimidine asymmetry. Figure 4 shows the same overview computed under Key 1. The four chemical-axis groups Keto, Strong, Amino, and Weak now become identical in  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , and  $\Delta$ , accounting for the visible uniformity in the top half of the figure.

#### 3.4.1 Alignment of the chemical-axis 32-codon groups

Under Key 1, the four 32-codon groups along the chemical axes Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak are aligned in all four nucleon quantities to the common values

$$T = 3996, \quad P = 2146, \quad N = 1850, \quad \Delta = 296.$$

The equality Keto = Amino follows from the balance conditions imposed during the derivation of  $n_{\text{stop}}$  and  $p_{\text{stop}}$ ; the identities Keto  $\equiv$  Strong and Amino  $\equiv$  Weak are parametrization-independent (Section 3.1.3). The numerical values of all group quantities under Key 1 are tabulated in `key1_nucleon-data.csv`.

Of the three axes that partition the codon table by third position — Keto/Amino, Strong/Weak, and Purine/Pyrimidine — only the first two yield this alignment. The Purine/Pyrimidine axis behaves differently and is analyzed in Section 3.4.5.

**Rational signature.** The alignment can be restated in projective form. Under Key 1, the whole code and the four chemical-axis 32-codon groups share a single rational profile of nucleon ratios,

$$\frac{P}{T} = \frac{29}{54}, \quad \frac{N}{T} = \frac{25}{54}, \quad \frac{\Delta}{T} = \frac{2}{27},$$

with  $P : N = 29 : 25$ . For each of these four 32-codon groups, its 16-codon half in Octet II carries  $T = 2146 = 29 \cdot 2 \cdot 37$ , equal to the full proton sum of the group, whereas its half in Octet I carries  $T = 1850 = 25 \cdot 2 \cdot 37$ , equal to its full neutron sum. The profile therefore reproduces the same pairing of  $P$  with Octet II and  $N$  with Octet I as the macroscopic identities of Section 3.4.2. The ratio profiles of all groups are tabulated in `key1_ratios.csv`.

#### 3.4.2 Macroscopic identities and propagation to chemical-axis halves

Under Key 1, the global nucleon pools of the standard code satisfy three identities relating them to the structural totals of the two octets:

$$\begin{aligned} N(\text{All}) &= T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700, \\ P(\text{All}) &= T(\text{Octet II}) = 4292, \\ N(\text{Octet II}) &= P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000. \end{aligned}$$

The first identity records the cross-parameter equality already noted in Section 3.3.1: the global neutron pool of the code under Key 1 equals the parametrization-independent chemical constant  $T(\text{Octet I})$ . The second is the analogue on the proton side, with  $P(\text{All}) = 4292$  matching  $T(\text{Octet II})$  evaluated under Key 1; unlike  $T(\text{Octet I})$ , the right-hand side here depends on the service-codon parametrization. The third identity restates the first at the level of individual



|                       |        |                |      |                    |        |                        |      |                 |        |                |    |
|-----------------------|--------|----------------|------|--------------------|--------|------------------------|------|-----------------|--------|----------------|----|
| ALL: {C, G, A, T}     |        |                |      | T: 7992 /999=8     | 64     |                        |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        |                |      | P: 4292 /37=116    |        |                        |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        |                |      | N: 3700 /37=100    |        |                        |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        |                |      | Δ: 592 /37=16      | 1      |                        |      |                 |        |                |    |
| Keto: {G, T}          |        | T: 3996 /999=4 | 32   | Amino: {A, C}      |        | T: 3996 /999=4         | 32   |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | P: 2146 /37=58 |      |                    |        | P: 2146 /37=58         |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | N: 1850 /37=50 |      |                    |        | N: 1850 /37=50         |      |                 |        |                |    |
| Strong: {C, G}        |        | Δ: 296 /37=8   | 2, 3 | Weak: {A, T}       |        | Δ: 296 /37=8           | 4, 5 |                 |        |                |    |
| Purine: {A, G}        |        | T: 3896        | 32   | Pyrimidine: {C, T} |        | T: 4096                | 32   |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | P: 2096        |      |                    |        | P: 2196                |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | N: 1800        |      |                    |        | N: 1900                |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 296 /37=8   | 6    |                    |        | Δ: 296 /37=8           | 7    |                 |        |                |    |
| {C}                   | 16     | T: 2048        | 16   | {G}                | 16     | T: 1948                | 16   |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | P: 1098        |      |                    |        | P: 1048                |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | N: 950         |      |                    |        | N: 900                 |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 148 /37=4   | 8    |                    |        | Δ: 148 /37=4           | 9    |                 |        |                |    |
| {T}                   | 16     | T: 2048        | 16   | {A}                | 16     | T: 1948                | 16   |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | P: 1098        |      |                    |        | P: 1048                |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | N: 950         |      |                    |        | N: 900                 |      |                 |        |                |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 148 /37=4   | 10   |                    |        | Δ: 148 /37=4           | 11   |                 |        |                |    |
| Octet I: {C, G, A, T} |        |                |      | T: 3700 /37=100    | 32     | Octet II: {C, G, A, T} |      | T: 4292 /37=116 | 32     |                |    |
|                       |        |                |      | P: 2000            |        |                        |      | P: 2292         |        |                |    |
|                       |        |                |      | N: 1700            |        |                        |      | N: 2000         |        |                |    |
|                       |        |                |      | Δ: 300             | 12     |                        |      | Δ: 292          | 23     |                |    |
| {G, T}                | 16     | T: 1850 /37=50 | 16   | {A, C}             | 16     | T: 1850 /37=50         | 16   | {G, T}          | 16     | T: 2146 /37=58 | 16 |
|                       |        | P: 1000        |      |                    |        | P: 1000                |      |                 |        | P: 1146        |    |
|                       |        | N: 850         |      |                    |        | N: 850                 |      |                 |        | N: 1000        |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 150         |      |                    |        | Δ: 150                 |      |                 |        | Δ: 146         |    |
| {C, G}                | 13, 14 |                |      | {A, T}             | 15, 16 |                        |      | {C, G}          | 24, 25 |                |    |
| {A, G}                | 16     | T: 1850 /37=50 | 16   | {C, T}             | 16     | T: 1850 /37=50         | 16   | {A, G}          | 16     | T: 2046        | 16 |
|                       |        | P: 1000        |      |                    |        | P: 1000                |      |                 |        | P: 1096        |    |
|                       |        | N: 850         |      |                    |        | N: 850                 |      |                 |        | N: 950         |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 150         | 17   |                    |        | Δ: 150                 | 18   |                 |        | Δ: 146         | 28 |
| {C}                   | 8      | T: 925 /37=25  | 8    | {G}                | 8      | T: 925 /37=25          | 8    | {C}             | 8      | T: 1123        | 8  |
|                       |        | P: 500         |      |                    |        | P: 500                 |      |                 |        | P: 598         |    |
|                       |        | N: 425         |      |                    |        | N: 425                 |      |                 |        | N: 525         |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 75          | 19   |                    |        | Δ: 75                  | 20   |                 |        | Δ: 73          | 30 |
| {T}                   | 8      | T: 925 /37=25  | 8    | {A}                | 8      | T: 925 /37=25          | 8    | {T}             | 8      | T: 1123        | 8  |
|                       |        | P: 500         |      |                    |        | P: 500                 |      |                 |        | P: 598         |    |
|                       |        | N: 425         |      |                    |        | N: 425                 |      |                 |        | N: 525         |    |
|                       |        | Δ: 75          | 21   |                    |        | Δ: 75                  | 22   |                 |        | Δ: 73          | 32 |
|                       |        |                |      |                    |        |                        |      |                 |        |                | 33 |

Figure 4: The same overview as Figure 3, computed under the analytically derived parametrization Key 1, in which all four service codons are treated as formal parameters: the three stop codons contribute  $(P, N) = (37, 37)$  each, and ATG contributes  $(P, N) = (1, 0)$  (the methionine value of ATG is not used). Under this parametrization the four chemical-axis 32-codon groups Keto, Strong, Amino, Weak become identical in  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , and  $\Delta$  (top half of the figure). Generated by the accompanying [visualization.html](#).

octets: since  $T(\text{Octet I}) = P(\text{Octet I}) + N(\text{Octet I})$  tautologically, with chemical constants  $P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$  and  $N(\text{Octet I}) = 1700$ , the equality  $N(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet I})$  from the first identity gives  $N(\text{Octet II}) = 2000 = P(\text{Octet I})$ .

Combining the macroscopic identities with the alignment of the four chemical-axis groups (Section 3.4.1) gives

$$N(\text{Keto}) = N(\text{Amino}) = N(\text{Strong}) = N(\text{Weak}) = 1850 = \frac{1}{2} T(\text{Octet I}),$$

$$P(\text{Keto}) = P(\text{Amino}) = P(\text{Strong}) = P(\text{Weak}) = 2146 = \frac{1}{2} T(\text{Octet II}).$$

Each chemical-axis half of the code carries exactly half of the structural total of the corresponding octet. The same two values reappear at the 16-codon level inside the octets. Each of the six 16-codon sub-groups of Octet I carries  $T = 1850$ , equal across the six sub-groups because each 4-fold degenerate family of Octet I contributes the same amino acid nucleon to every 16-codon partition. Inside Octet II, the four 16-codon sub-groups along the chemical axes Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak carry  $T = 2146$  under Key 1; the two sub-groups along the Purine/Pyrimidine axis are not aligned with this value (Section 3.4.5). The cross-parameter equality  $N(\text{Octet II}) = P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$  similarly resolves at the 16-codon level: each 16-codon sub-group of Octet I carries  $P = 1000$ , and each chemical-axis 16-codon sub-group of Octet II carries  $N = 1000$  under Key 1. The full set of equalities arising under Key 1, classified by relation type, is tabulated in `key1_equalities.csv`.

**A parametrization-independent counterpart on the proton side.** The value 2000 that appears in the cross-parameter identity  $N(\text{Octet II}) = P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$  also arises elsewhere in the arithmetic of the code, on the proton side and without reference to any service-codon parametrization. The sense pool of Octet II carries  $P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Octet II}) = 2180$ ; subtracting the single pair Trp and Ile that localizes the Keto/Amino asymmetry (Section 3.1.5) gives

$$P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Octet II}) - (P(\text{Trp}) + P(\text{Ile})) = 2180 - 180 = 2000 = P(\text{Octet I}).$$

The proton excess of Octet II over Octet I at the sense-pool level coincides exactly with the proton count of the localizing pair:  $P(\text{Trp}) + P(\text{Ile}) = 180 = P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Octet II}) - P(\text{Octet I})$ . The analogous identity for neutrons does not hold —  $N(\text{Trp}) + N(\text{Ile}) = 155$ , while  $N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Octet II}) - N(\text{Octet I}) = 189$ , a residual difference of 34 — and the failure of the neutron analogue indicates that the proton equality is a numerical coincidence rather than a structural regularity. It is recorded as an illustration of the recurrence of the value 2000 and carries no independent evidential weight.

### 3.4.3 Divisibility by 37 and by 999

The arithmetic of Key 1 is organized by two divisibility properties of the standard code. The divisibility by 37 was imposed during the derivation of  $n_{\text{stop}}$  and  $p_{\text{stop}}$  for the global pools  $N(\text{All})$  and  $P(\text{All})$ ; under Key 1 it extends to many further group quantities. The divisibility by 999 is not required by the system and holds independently for the total nucleon pool.

**Divisibility by 37.** Under Key 1, divisibility by 37 holds for the global neutron and proton pools, and for the 32-codon groups along the chemical axes Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak in  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , and  $\Delta$ :

$$N(\text{All}) = 100 \cdot 37,$$

$$P(\text{All}) = 116 \cdot 37,$$

$$T(\text{Keto}) = T(\text{Amino}) = T(\text{Strong}) = T(\text{Weak}) = 108 \cdot 37,$$

$$P(\text{Keto}) = P(\text{Amino}) = P(\text{Strong}) = P(\text{Weak}) = 58 \cdot 37,$$

$$N(\text{Keto}) = N(\text{Amino}) = N(\text{Strong}) = N(\text{Weak}) = 50 \cdot 37,$$

$$\Delta(\text{Keto}) = \Delta(\text{Amino}) = \Delta(\text{Strong}) = \Delta(\text{Weak}) = 8 \cdot 37.$$

By the first two macroscopic identities of Section 3.4.2, divisibility by 37 also extends to the global proton-neutron imbalance:  $\Delta(\text{All}) = P(\text{All}) - N(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet II}) - T(\text{Octet I}) = 16 \cdot 37 = 592$ . The full set of divisibility records under Key 1 is tabulated in `key1_divisibility-37.csv`.

**Divisibility by 999.** Under Key 1, the global total nucleon pool of the standard code and each of the four chemical-axis 32-codon groups in  $T$  satisfy

$$T(\text{All}) = 7992 = 8 \cdot 999, \quad T(\text{Keto}) = T(\text{Amino}) = T(\text{Strong}) = T(\text{Weak}) = 3996 = 4 \cdot 999.$$

The system of conditions imposed in Section 3.3 requires divisibility by 37 but not by the higher modulus  $999 = 27 \cdot 37$ . In factored form  $T(\text{All}) = 2^3 \cdot 3^3 \cdot 37 = 6^3 \cdot 37$ . The divisibility of  $T(\text{All})$  and  $T(\text{half})$  by 999 is a further property of the standard code under Key 1; being neither required by the derivation nor parametrization-independent, it is recorded but carries no independent evidential weight.

### 3.4.4 The $\Delta$ -invariant across all six 32-codon groups

Under Key 1, all six 32-codon groups defined by the third codon position carry the same value of the proton-neutron difference:

$$\Delta(\text{Keto}) = \Delta(\text{Amino}) = \Delta(\text{Strong}) = \Delta(\text{Weak}) = \Delta(\text{Purine}) = \Delta(\text{Pyrimidine}) = 296.$$

For the four groups along the chemical axes Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak, this follows from the alignment in  $P$  and  $N$  established in Section 3.4.1: equal  $P$  and equal  $N$  imply equal  $\Delta$ . For the Purine and Pyrimidine groups, which are not aligned in  $T$ ,  $P$ , or  $N$  (Section 3.4.5), the  $\Delta$ -equality is independent of the alignment: the  $P$ -shift and the  $N$ -shift between the two groups coincide in magnitude, so that their difference  $\Delta = P - N$  is preserved across all three axes.

The common value  $\Delta = 296$  resolves through a cascade joining the lower partition levels. At the 8-codon level, every 8-codon sub-group of Octet I carries  $\Delta = 75$  as a parametrization-independent property of the 4-fold-degenerate families (Section 3.1.2), and every 8-codon sub-group of Octet II carries  $\Delta = 73$  under Key 1 (paralleling the  $\Delta$ -pattern of Section 3.1.4):

$$\Delta(G_X \cap \text{Octet I}) = 75, \quad \Delta(G_X \cap \text{Octet II}) = 73 \quad (|X| = 1).$$

The 16-codon level reproduces these values along two distinct partitions of the code. Within each octet, every 16-codon sub-group inherits twice the corresponding 8-codon value,

$$\Delta(G_X \cap \text{Octet I}) = 150, \quad \Delta(G_X \cap \text{Octet II}) = 146 \quad (|X| = 2).$$

Across octets, each single-base 16-codon group of the full code joins one 8-codon sub-group of Octet I with one of Octet II, giving

$$\Delta(\{C\}) = \Delta(\{G\}) = \Delta(\{T\}) = \Delta(\{A\}) = 75 + 73 = 148 = 4 \cdot 37$$

at All-code level (ids 8–11). This four-way equality is specific to Key 1: under Key 0 the placement of the start codon ATG as methionine in  $\{G\}$  shifts  $\Delta(\{G\})$  to 158, breaking the symmetry with the remaining three single-base groups. The two 16-codon paths converge at the 32-codon level: the common value  $\Delta = 296 = 2 \cdot 148 = 150 + 146$  obtains either as the sum of two single-base 16-codon groups along any axis, or equivalently as the sum of the 16-codon sub-groups of Octet I and Octet II along the same axis.

### 3.4.5 Purine/Pyrimidine asymmetry

The Purine/Pyrimidine axis is the one chemical axis on which the standard code is not aligned in  $T$ ,  $P$ , or  $N$ . Under Key 1,

$$\begin{aligned} N(\text{Pyrimidine}) - N(\text{Purine}) &= 100, \\ P(\text{Pyrimidine}) - P(\text{Purine}) &= 100, \\ T(\text{Pyrimidine}) - T(\text{Purine}) &= 200, \\ \Delta(\text{Pyrimidine}) - \Delta(\text{Purine}) &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

The asymmetry is localized in Octet II. Within Octet I, Purine and Pyrimidine contain equal proton and neutron pools as a parametrization-independent consequence of 4-fold degeneracy (Section 3.1); the imbalance arises entirely from Octet II, where all four service codons reside in the Purine branch (third position A or G).

The shifts in  $P$  and  $N$  are equal in magnitude (100 in each), and this magnitude equality is what preserves the  $\Delta$ -invariant across the Purine and Pyrimidine groups (Section 3.4.4). At the level of the sense pool alone, the two shifts are not equal:

$$P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Pyrimidine}) - P_{\text{SE}}(\text{Purine}) = 212, \quad N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Pyrimidine}) - N_{\text{SE}}(\text{Purine}) = 211,$$

with a residual proton-neutron asymmetry of one in favor of  $P$ . Under Key 1, the service codons add 112 protons and 111 neutrons to the Purine branch: one ATG with  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$ ,  $n_{\text{start}} = 0$ , plus three stop codons each with  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}} = 37$ . The proton-neutron asymmetry of the service increments matches that of the sense pool. Adding these increments to the Purine branch reduces the Pyrimidine–Purine proton difference from 212 to 100 and the neutron difference from 211 to 100, equalizing the two macroscopic shifts.

**Purine synonymy at the single-base level under Key 1.** At the 16-codon level, the four single-base groups of the full code split into two pairs by their  $(T, P, N)$  profiles:

$$\begin{aligned} T(\{C\}) = T(\{T\}) &= 2048, & P(\{C\}) = P(\{T\}) &= 1098, & N(\{C\}) = N(\{T\}) &= 950, \\ T(\{G\}) = T(\{A\}) &= 1948, & P(\{G\}) = P(\{A\}) &= 1048, & N(\{G\}) = N(\{A\}) &= 900, \end{aligned}$$

while  $\Delta$  remains uniform across all four groups (Section 3.4.4). The pyrimidine equality  $\{C\} \equiv \{T\}$  is parametrization-independent and follows from the universal C/T synonymy at the family level (Section 3.1.3). The purine equality  $\{G\} \equiv \{A\}$  is specific to Key 1, with the mechanism local to Octet II: the branches  $\{G\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  and  $\{A\} \cap \text{Octet II}$  contain asymmetrically distributed service codons (ATG and TAG in  $\{G\}$  versus TAA and TGA in  $\{A\}$ ), and the symmetrized Key 1 values cancel the corresponding sense-pool asymmetries exactly:

$$\{G\} \cap \text{Octet II} = \{A\} \cap \text{Octet II} = (T = 1023, P = 548, N = 475).$$

The Pyrimidine pair and the Purine pair differ by exactly 100 in  $T$  and 50 in each of  $P$  and  $N$ ; doubling these shifts reproduces the macroscopic Purine/Pyrimidine asymmetry at the 32-codon level.

**Inside Octet II at the 16-codon level.** The 16-codon sub-groups along the Purine/Pyrimidine axis carry

$$\begin{aligned} N(\text{Purine} \cap \text{Octet II}) &= 950, & N(\text{Pyrimidine} \cap \text{Octet II}) &= 1050, \\ P(\text{Purine} \cap \text{Octet II}) &= 1096, & P(\text{Pyrimidine} \cap \text{Octet II}) &= 1196, \end{aligned}$$

showing a  $\pm 50$  deviation from the values carried by the 16-codon sub-groups of Octet II along the Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak axes, which under Key 1 are  $N = 1000$  and  $P = 1146$  (Section 3.4.2). The Purine and Pyrimidine branches of Octet II thus straddle the values of the other two axes symmetrically.

### 3.5 Synthesis

The results above separate along the three levels of Section 3. The parametrization-independent level (Section 3.1) carries the structure: the sense-pool neutron divisibility and proton residue, the localization of the Keto/Amino asymmetry in a single amino-acid pair, and the Octet I and pyrimidine constants. These are the load-bearing findings, and they need no assignment to the service codons. The naive reading (Section 3.2) already exhibits much of the same structure. Key 1 (Sections 3.3–3.4) adds no new structure: it is the unique minimal integer assignment under which the parametrization-independent regularities extend cleanly to the full 64-codon table. Within the Key 1 level a distinction remains between relations that follow algebraically from the imposed balance conditions and relations that hold under Key 1 without following from them; this subsection collects the results under these headings.

**Why the extension is solvable in small integers.** The parametrization-independent facts of Section 3.1 are what make the service-codon system of Sections 3.3.1–3.3.2 solvable in small non-negative integers. Three enter directly: the Keto/Amino asymmetry reduces to the single pair Trp–Ile with  $|\delta N| = 37$  and  $|\delta P| = 36$  (Section 3.1.5); the sense pool carries  $N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 97 \cdot 37$  and  $P(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$  (Section 3.1.1); and the even-proton property forbids  $|\delta P| = 37$  (Section 3.1.5). The deficits then close arithmetically: the neutron deficit  $T(\text{Octet I}) - N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 3 \cdot 37 = 111$  is a multiple both of the number of stops and of the modulus 37; the proton residue  $-1$  is the smallest non-zero contribution the start codon can make; and  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$  reduces the combined condition to a unique minimal solution rather than one admitting multiple small residues. The neutron and proton systems are formally independent, yet their minimal solutions coincide at  $p_{\text{stop}} = n_{\text{stop}} = 37$ . Across the alternative NCBI tables (Section 4.1) this arithmetic match holds only for the standard code and its exact codon-to-amino-acid equivalent.

**Algebraic consequences of the Key 1 system.** The balance conditions imposed during the derivation directly equate the Keto and Amino groups in  $N$  and  $P$ . Combined with the parametrization-independent identities  $\text{Keto} \equiv \text{Strong}$  and  $\text{Amino} \equiv \text{Weak}$  (Section 3.1.3), this aligns the four 32-codon groups along the Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak axes in all four nucleon quantities  $(T, P, N, \Delta)$  (Section 3.4.1). From the alignment follow the half-code identities  $N(\text{half}) = \frac{1}{2}T(\text{Octet I})$  and  $P(\text{half}) = \frac{1}{2}T(\text{Octet II})$ , and the divisibility of their nucleon quantities by 37.

**Independent observations under Key 1.** The remaining identities hold under the parametrization without following from the balance conditions. The global neutron pool reaches  $N(\text{All}) = 3700$ , the minimal admissible multiple of 37, which coincides with the parametrization-independent constant  $T(\text{Octet I})$ ; the equivalent statement at the level of individual octets is  $N(\text{Octet II}) = P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$ , a cross-parameter equality between a parametric quantity and a chemical constant. The analogous proton identity  $P(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet II}) = 4292$  holds under the same parametrization, completing the dual pairing between the global nucleon pools and the two octets, and follows from the neutron identity together with  $T = P + N$  (Section 3.4.2). The total nucleon pool satisfies  $T(\text{All}) = 8 \cdot 999$ , a divisibility by the higher modulus 999 not present among the imposed conditions (Section 3.4.3). The  $\Delta$ -invariant  $\Delta = 296$  extends to all six 32-codon groups, including the Purine and Pyrimidine groups, which are not aligned in  $T$ ,  $P$  or  $N$  (Section 3.4.4). On the Purine/Pyrimidine axis, the proton and neutron shifts between the two groups are equal and both take the value 100, with the equality of the two shifts following from the matching of the parity-induced unit shift between the sense pool and the parametric increments (Section 3.4.5). At the single-base level, the purine equality  $\{G\} \equiv \{A\}$  holds under Key 1 in addition to the parametrization-independent pyrimidine equality  $\{C\} \equiv \{T\}$ . A parametrization-independent counterpart on the proton side gives  $P_{SE}(\text{Octet II}) - (P(\text{Trp}) + P(\text{Ile})) = P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$ :

the proton excess of Octet II over Octet I on the sense pool coincides exactly with the proton mass of the localizing pair, an identity that does not hold for neutrons.

**A proton-side offset of one unit.** In the parametrization-independent arithmetic, two neutron quantities meet the 37-lattice exactly while the corresponding proton quantities fall one unit short. The sense pool carries  $N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 97 \cdot 37$  against  $P(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 113 \cdot 37 - 1$ ; the single pair Trp-Ile that localizes the Keto/Amino asymmetry has  $|\delta N| = 37$  against  $|\delta P| = 36$ . The derived parametrization then closes the offset with one extra proton on the start codon,  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$ , where the neutron side requires none,  $n_{\text{start}} = 0$ . The common cause is the even-proton property of the canonical amino acids (Section 3.1.5): a sum or difference of even proton counts is even and cannot equal an odd multiple of 37, so both 37 itself and  $113 \cdot 37$  are unreachable on the proton side. That the miss is exactly one unit in each case, rather than a larger margin, is a property of the specific nucleon counts and is not fixed by parity alone.

**Two recurrent integers: 37 and the round-number scale.** The integer 37 appears at all three levels of the structure and in roles not directly connected by the derivation. At the parametrization-independent level it is the common denominator of the Octet I ratios, the divisor of the sense pool  $N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 97 \cdot 37$ , and the value of  $|\delta N(\text{Trp, Ile})|$ . Under Key 0 it organizes the alignment of the Amino and Weak groups and their sub-group  $\{A\}$  with the 37-lattice (Section 3.2). Under Key 1 it is the modulus of the imposed divisibility conditions, the common value of the stop-codon parameters, and a divisor of the nucleon quantities of the aligned 32-codon groups. These occurrences meet at the cross-parameter identity  $N(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet I})$ , where the parametrization-independent value  $100 \cdot 37$  and the Key 1-level divisibility of  $N(\text{All})$  by 37 fall on the same number. That a topological quantity of Octet I, a global neutron sum, and the neutron difference of a single amino-acid pair are all expressed through the same modulus, although none of these is derived from the others, indicates that the regularities form a connected whole rather than separate coincidences; the identities relating them, such as  $T(\text{Octet I}) - N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 3 \cdot |\delta N(\text{Trp, Ile})|$ , follow once the shared modulus is granted and add no independent divisibility of their own.

A second integer scale is also visible in the arithmetic of the code. The parametrization-independent constants of Octet I —  $P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$ ,  $N(\text{Octet I}) = 1700$ ,  $\Delta(\text{Octet I}) = 300$  — are all multiples of 100, with  $P(\text{Octet I})$  a multiple of 1000. Under Key 1 the cross-parameter equality  $N(\text{Octet II}) = P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$  brings the neutron content of Octet II onto the same scale, and the neutron pools of the Purine and Pyrimidine groups satisfy  $N(\text{Purine}) = 1800$  and  $N(\text{Pyrimidine}) = 1900$ . The Purine/Pyrimidine shifts in  $P$  and  $N$  take the value 100 at the 32-codon level and  $\pm 50$  at the 16-codon level. These round-number occurrences do not reduce to the multiplier 37 and constitute a separate arithmetic regularity of the standard code under Key 1.

## 4 Discussion

This section examines how far the regularities reported above are specific to the standard code and its structure, rather than artifacts of the analysis. Section 4.1 compares the standard code against the alternative NCBI codes on the sense-pool arithmetic, testing both the global alignment with the 37-lattice and the robustness of the Trp-Ile localization; Section 4.2 asks whether the third codon position and the modulus 37 are distinguished from other positions and divisors; and Section 4.3 assesses the concentration on the 37-lattice against a random-code null. Section 4.4 situates the results relative to prior work, and Section 4.5 states the limitations and outlook.



## 4.1 Specificity across alternative genetic codes

The standard genetic code is one of 27 translation tables in the NCBI registry. The parametrization-independent sense-pool arithmetic of Section 3.1 admits direct comparative tests across these tables: for each alternative code one can ask whether the same arithmetic holds. Two such tests are reported here. The first concerns the global alignment of the sense pool with the lattice of step 37—the neutron deficit and the proton residue of Section 3.1.1. The second concerns the localization of the Keto/Amino asymmetry in the single pair Trp-Ile (Section 3.1.5). Both quantities are properties of the sense pool and require no assignment to the service codons; the closure of the first pair under Key 1 is a separate matter, treated in Section 3.3. The two tests probe different aspects of the arithmetic and, as shown below, identify different sets of matching alternative codes.

Because both tests depend on which codons are counted as stops, both are computed under two model choices for the sense pool:

- Sense pool, Model 1 (primary): all codons listed as stops in the NCBI registry are excluded, even when they are read as amino acids in context-dependent codes. The primary start codon ATG is excluded as the universal initiator. Initiation is a property of the first codon position rather than of the triplet itself, so exactly one initiator codon is removed; alternative start codons such as GTG and TTG carry their elongation meaning at every internal position and are counted as sense codons.
- Sense pool, Model 2 (alternative): in the three codes with context-dependent stops (Tables 27, 28, 31), codons that function as amino acids in mid-sequence and as stops at gene termini are treated as sense codons. For all other tables, Model 2 coincides with Model 1.

The model conventions are documented in the datasets accompanying `deficit_models_analysis.csv` and `keto_amino_balance_models.csv`.

**Global alignment of the sense pool with the lattice.** The first test records two quantities of the sense pool: the neutron deficit relative to a reference total,  $\Delta_N = T_{\text{ref}} - N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}})$ , and the proton residue  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \bmod 37$ . For the standard code these are  $\Delta_N = T(\text{Octet I}) - N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 3700 - 3589 = 111 = 3 \cdot 37$  and  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$  (Section 3.1.1); under Key 1 the first deficit is closed by the three stop codons to align  $N(\text{All})$  with the invariant  $T(\text{Octet I})$ , and the proton residue by the start-codon parameter  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$ . For the neutron deficit, three model choices of  $T_{\text{ref}}$  are considered: the constant  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700$  of the standard code, the total nucleon content of the eight structural Octet I families under the amino-acid assignments of the specific table, and the total nucleon content of all 4-fold degenerate codon families in the specific table. For the proton residue the relevant quantity is intrinsic to the sense pool and requires no reference total. The full set of computed values across all tables and model combinations is tabulated in `deficit_models_analysis.csv`.

The two records give parallel outcomes: in each, the arithmetic property holds in exactly the same three tables. Table 1 (the standard code) and Table 11 (the Bacterial, Archaeal and Plant Plastid Code) have  $\Delta_N = 111 = 3 \cdot 37$  under all three reference models and  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$  under both sense-pool models; their amino acid assignments are identical and they share the same set of stop codons, so arithmetically they are the same code applied in different domains. Table 28 (the *Condyllostoma* Nuclear Code) gives the same values as the standard code under Model 1 and different values under Model 2: its three context-dependent stop codons, once excluded alongside ATG, leave a sense codon set identical to the one used for the standard code, whereas under Model 2 they are returned to the pool and neither the deficit nor the residue matches. In the remaining 24 tables neither property holds under any model combination. That the two records identify the same tables reflects a single underlying sense pool rather than

independent agreement: Tables 1, 11, and (under Model 1) 28 all share the standard code’s sense-codon assignments.

Across the 27 tables, six reasonable definitions of the neutron deficit and two of the proton residue, only the standard code and its exact codon-to-amino-acid equivalent (Table 11) satisfy both conditions under every model. Tables that reassign codons within the structural Octet I families, shift the set of 4-fold-degenerate families, or use a different number of stop codons destroy the match between the sense pool and the lattice of step 37. The global alignment is therefore not a generic feature of genetic codes.

**Preservation of the Trp–Ile localization.** The second test asks whether the localization of the Keto/Amino asymmetry in the pair Trp–Ile survives in alternative codes. The relevant signature is the pair of sense-pool differences  $N_{SE}(Keto) - N_{SE}(Amino) = 37$  and  $P_{SE}(Keto) - P_{SE}(Amino) = 36$ , the (37, 36) signature; the values across all tables are computed in `keto_amino_balance_models.csv`. The signature is reproduced exactly in seven tables. Five—Table 1 (Standard), Table 6 (Ciliate, Dasycladacean and Hexamita Nuclear), Table 11 (Bacterial, Archaeal and Plant Plastid), Table 29 (Mesodinium Nuclear), and Table 30 (Peritrich Nuclear)—reproduce it under both sense-pool models; the remaining two, Table 27 (Karyorelict Nuclear) and Table 28 (Condylostoma Nuclear), reproduce it only under the primary interpretation of context-dependent stop codons.

The mechanism is structural and operates differently in different tables. Table 11 has an amino acid assignment identical to the standard code and shares its set of stop codons, so the signature holds trivially. In Tables 6, 29, and 30 the codons TAG and TAA are reassigned to the same amino acid (Gln, Tyr, or Glu respectively); since TAG sits in the Keto branch of family TA and TAA in the Amino branch, this symmetric reassignment contributes identically to both branches of the sense pool and the Keto/Amino differences are preserved. No codons other than TAA and TAG are reassigned in these tables; in particular, neither TGG (Trp) nor any codon of Ile is changed, and the Trp/Ile localization of Section 3.1.5 continues to hold. Tables 27 and 28 involve context-dependent stop codons and behave differently under the two models: Table 28 declares all three of TAA, TAG, TGA as context-dependent stops, so under Model 1 its sense pool is identical to that of the standard code and the signature is reproduced, while under Model 2 the three codons re-enter the pool and it is lost; Table 27 permanently reassigns TAA and TAG to Gln (the same symmetric mechanism) and treats only TGA as a context-dependent stop, so Model 1 preserves the signature while Model 2, including TGA as Trp in the Keto branch, breaks it. Tables that reassign ATA (typically to Met in mitochondrial codes) or TGA (typically from stop to Trp) change the amino acid content of the carrier codons and no longer reproduce the signature.

The asymmetry between nuclear and mitochondrial codes is informative. All seven tables matching the (37, 36) signature are nuclear or bacterial; none of the thirteen mitochondrial translation tables in the NCBI registry reproduces it, the failure tracing in each case to the reassignment of ATA or TGA, both altering codons on which the localization depends.

**Relation between the two tests.** A finer decomposition connects the seven matching tables to the first test. In the standard code the four sense-pool half-quantities have the residues  $(N_{Keto}, N_{Amino}, P_{Keto}, P_{Amino}) \equiv (0, 0, -1, 0) \pmod{37}$ , an arithmetic profile combining divisibility of each half-pool by 37 with a one-unit proton residue: parity bars the proton half-pools from the odd multiples of 37, and the specific nucleon counts place the residue at exactly one. Tables 1, 11, and 28 (under Model 1) reproduce all four residues exactly—for Table 11 by identity with the standard code, for Table 28 under Model 1 because its sense pool coincides with the standard once the context-dependent stops are excluded—and these are exactly the three tables that match in the global-alignment test above. The four additional tables matching the (37, 36) signature (6, 27, 29, 30) show a different profile:  $N_{Keto}$  and  $N_{Amino}$  share the same non-zero

residue mod 37, and  $P_{\text{Keto}}$  and  $P_{\text{Amino}}$  differ by one unit, but the absolute level has detached from the lattice. This is the signature of symmetric reassignment of TAA and TAG to a common amino acid: each half-pool acquires the same non-zero contribution, so the Keto/Amino differences are preserved while the divisibility of each half by 37 is lost. Among the 27 tables, 13 preserve the divisibility of at least one half-pool by 37, three of them mitochondrial (Tables 4, 16, and 23).

The global-alignment test measures the absolute alignment of the whole sense pool with the 37-lattice and matches only tables arithmetically equivalent to the standard code in their sense pool (Tables 1, 11, and 28 under Model 1). The localization test measures the preservation of a relational pattern between the Keto and Amino branches and additionally matches tables in which the only divergence from the standard code is a symmetric reassignment of TAA and TAG (Tables 6, 27, 29, 30). Together they show that the parametrization-independent sense-pool arithmetic of the standard code, in both its absolute and its relational form, is specific to the standard code among the known natural codes, holding elsewhere only in tables that are arithmetically equivalent to it or differ from it by a symmetric reassignment of TAA and TAG.

## 4.2 Specificity of the third codon position, the modulus 37, and the molecular representation

Two features are built into the framework of this work rather than derived from the data: the three chemical axes are read off the third codon position (Section 2.3), and divisibility by 37 is the primary criterion (Section 2.5). Two deterministic controls test whether the observed structure is specific to these two choices or would arise generically.

**Codon position.** Applying the same three chemical axes to the first and second codon position, instead of the third, removes the structure almost entirely. At the third position the Amino and Weak groups have all four nucleon quantities divisible by 37, the Keto and Strong groups have their neutron pool divisible, and the Pyrimidine group has  $\Delta$  divisible. At the first position the only divisibility is the neutron pool of the Keto/Amino axis, present in both its complementary halves, and this is not an independent fact: Keto and Amino are complementary, so their sense-pool neutron counts sum to  $N(C_{\text{SE}}) = 3589 = 97 \cdot 37$  (Section 3.3.1), and divisibility of one half forces divisibility of the other. At the second position no nucleon quantity of any axis is divisible by 37. The control thus shows that divisibility by 37 along the chemical axes is confined to the third codon position: the same axes applied to the first and second positions do not meet the 37-lattice, the single first-position exception being the dependent one noted above. This excludes the alternative in which any equal-size split of the sense pool into chemical halves would align with the 37-lattice irrespective of position. The full values for all three positions are tabulated in `position_axis_analysis.csv`.

**Choice of modulus.** For every prime up to 97 we count how many of the four nucleon quantities of the codon groups it divides, over three value sets: the parametrization-independent groups (those with no service codon, on which 37 cannot be imposed), the groups under Key 0 (which does not impose 37), and the groups under Key 1 (whose derivation does). The scan ranges over primes rather than all integers because divisibility by a composite is the conjunction of divisibilities by its prime-power factors and introduces no new modulus, and because raising a prime to a higher power lowers the chance rate  $1/m$  and thereby inflates the excess over the same quantities without adding information; the prime is the appropriate unit. The informative statistic is accordingly the excess over the chance rate  $1/p$ , computed over distinct values so that quantities forced to coincide by the structure of the code are not counted more than once.

Three primes divide their share at essentially the chance rate (3, 7 and 13). Two exceed it modestly, by less than a factor of three across the three value sets: 2, because every canonical amino acid has an even proton count (Section 3.1.5), and 5, reflecting the round-number regularity already reported in Section 3.5, which the scan thus corroborates. Against this background 37

divides five of the twenty-eight distinct parametrization-independent quantities, thirteen of the seventy distinct Key 0 quantities, and ten of the forty-seven under Key 1 — in each case several times the naive rate  $1/37$ . This excess ratio is descriptive, not a  $p$ -value: the scan is deterministic and has no null model, and the nested group hierarchy makes the quantities non-independent, so the ratio alone cannot be read as a significance. An additional descriptive distinction not captured by that ratio is that the multiples of 37 contain several distinct odd cores, whereas the comparable factors 73 and 61 each reduce to a single core. Because the effect is already present in the value sets where 37 is not imposed, it is in any case not an artifact of the Key 1 derivation.

Three features set 37 apart from the two small primes, all independent of the number base. It is a larger prime, so each divisible quantity is rarer under the null. It has no structural counterpart to proton parity. And, unlike 5 — whose multiples in these value sets are almost all multiples of 25, so that the larger excess one would attribute to 25, 50 or 100 only re-scores the same quantities against a smaller chance rate — the modulus 37 occurs at a single power: no quantity is divisible by  $37^2$ , so its excess does not grow when the modulus is enlarged. Reducing each quantity to its odd part — dividing out the powers of two that the nested group hierarchy (Octet I and its sixteen- and eight-codon sub-groups) introduces mechanically, since a group of size  $2k$  has twice the nucleon counts of its size- $k$  refinement — sharpens this. Among the Key 0 quantities, 37 divides ten distinct odd cores; the multiples of  $73 = 2 \cdot 37 - 1$  (the value of  $\Delta$  for the Octet II eight-codon groups) collapse to that single core, and the multiples of 61 to the single core  $549 = 9 \cdot 61$ , to which the pyrimidine proton pool  $P(\text{Pyrimidine}) = 2196 = 2^2 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 61 = 4 \cdot 549$  and the proton count of each pyrimidine letter  $1098 = 2 \cdot 549$  both reduce. The factor 73 is thus an echo of the modulus itself; the factor 61 is an isolated factorization unrelated to 37 (its quantities deviate from the nearest multiples of 37 by  $+13$  and  $-12$ , not by  $\pm 1$  or  $\pm 2$ ); and the factor 5 reduces entirely to 10 and 25, every quantity here divisible by 5 being divisible by 10 or by 25. The odd-core counts are tabulated in the corresponding column of `prime_divisibility_scan.csv`.

**Representation dependence and the invariant relational core.** The nucleon counts throughout are those of the free (neutral) amino acids — the canonical molecular identity of the species each codon encodes — under the most-abundant-isotope convention ( $^1\text{H}$ ,  $^{12}\text{C}$ ,  $^{14}\text{N}$ ,  $^{16}\text{O}$ ,  $^{32}\text{S}$ ). Any alternative representation of the encoded amino acid differs from this one by a fixed nucleon offset per residue: the peptide residue removes one water (10 protons, 8 neutrons), the zwitterion removes nothing. Under such a uniform offset  $(\delta P, \delta N)$ , a linear combination of the counts is invariant if and only if its signed codon coefficients sum to zero; the control `representation_sensitivity.csv` records every anchor under all three representations. This splits the regularities in two. The relational regularities — the neutron and proton differences of the localizing pair Trp-Ile ( $|\delta N| = 37$ ,  $|\delta P| = 36$ ) and the Keto/Amino and Strong/Weak axis differences (37, 36) — are differences between codon sets of equal cardinality and are therefore invariant under every such re-representation. The absolute regularities — the sense-pool sums  $N(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) = 97 \cdot 37$  and  $P(\mathcal{C}_{\text{SE}}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$ , the deficit  $111 = 3 \cdot 37$ , and the divisibility of the individual axis half-pools — are not: a uniform offset preserves the neutron alignment only when  $60\delta N \equiv 0 \pmod{37}$ , i.e.,  $\delta N \equiv 0$  (since  $\text{gcd}(60, 37) = 1$ ), which among the representations considered excludes the peptide residue, while the neutral and zwitterionic forms of the free amino acid have the same elemental composition and therefore the same nucleon counts; under the peptide residue the sums become  $N = 3109 \equiv 1$  and  $P = 3580 \equiv 28 \pmod{37}$ . The absolute alignment is therefore a property of the standard code’s assignment in the canonical free-amino-acid representation, fixed a priori by molecular convention rather than by tuning, while the relational structure — the load-bearing part of the analysis — is representation-independent.

**The functional-group asymmetry across positions.** One observation on the Keto/Amino axis reaches beyond the third position. The asymmetry  $N(\text{Keto}) - N(\text{Amino})$  that localizes to the Trp-Ile pair at the third position (Section 4.1) equals 37 there; the same Keto/Amino axis —

the  $\{G, T\}$  versus  $\{A, C\}$  split — yields a quantity divisible by 37 at the first position as well ( $N$ -asymmetry  $-333 = -9 \cdot 37$ ) and at the second ( $T$ -asymmetry  $185 = 5 \cdot 37$ ). The divisible quantity is  $N, T, N$  by position, fixed after inspection rather than in advance, so this is a single observation along one axis rather than a control of the kind above. The three are arithmetically independent: each is a sum over a different partition of the same sixty codons, and the divisibility at one position neither follows from nor implies it at another; what they share is only the choice of axis. Across the 27 NCBI translation tables, the result depends on the sense-pool model. Under Model 1, the full three-position signature occurs for Tables 1, 11, and 28, whereas under Model 2 it occurs only for Tables 1 and 11. Table 28 is not an independent replication under Model 1: after its three context-dependent stop codons are excluded, its analyzed pool is identical to that of the standard code. Thus, in neither model is the full signature reproduced by a table with a non-equivalent analyzed pool. Apart from these full matches, no table reaches more than one position. In particular, Tables 6, 29, and 30 reach only the third position under both models, whereas Table 27 reaches only the third position and only under Model 1. Three caveats further qualify it. Unlike the third-position case, the first- and second-position asymmetries do not localize to a single amino-acid pair — each receives contributions from nineteen of the twenty amino acids, because the cancellation that isolates Trp and Ile relies on third-position synonymy, which the other positions lack. Their non-divisible components carry no analogue of the parity-induced residue  $-1$  that accompanies the third-position value. And, as in Section 4.1, the 27 tables are not statistically independent, so this is evidence of specificity among natural codes rather than of improbability under a null model. The per-table values are tabulated in `position_asymmetry_ncbi.csv`.

All four controls are deterministic, use exact integer arithmetic, and are regenerated by `controls.py` (Section 2.6).

### 4.3 Significance under a random-code null

The controls of Section 4.2 show that divisibilities concentrate in third-position groupings and that modulus 37 stands out among the tested prime moduli; the comparison of Section 4.1 shows that, among the 27 NCBI translation tables, the tested combination occurs only in the standard code and its exact codon-to-amino-acid equivalent. Specificity among realized codes, however, is not improbability under an explicit null. We therefore test the standard code against a random-code null of the kind used in studies of genetic-code optimality [2]: the architecture of the code is held fixed (the 64 codons, the synonymous blocks with their sizes, the three stop codons, the Rumer partition, and the third-position axes), and the only thing randomized is which amino acid, carrying its fixed proton and neutron counts, occupies each of the twenty blocks. A trial is a uniformly random permutation of the twenty real paired proton and neutron profiles over the twenty synonymous blocks. The modulus 37 is taken a priori from the prior literature; the statistical summaries were formally defined before the final Monte Carlo run. Because the analysis was not preregistered before inspection of the observed structure, the results are interpreted as exploratory.

S1–S3 and S4sense are evaluated over the sixty-codon sense pool without assigning any values to service codons. S4sense averages the distances to the nearest multiple of 37 for the four quantities  $T, P, N$ , and  $\Delta$  over all 33 groups, for 132 distances in total. Under S4a the stop codons contribute zero, while the contribution at ATG in each random code is the profile of the amino acid assigned by the permutation to the ATG block. Under S4b each random code receives its own minimal non-negative Key 1, re-derived by the same Keto/Amino balance and global divisibility conditions used for the standard code.

For every statistic the Monte Carlo tail probability is calculated as  $p_{MC} = (b + 1)/(M + 1)$ , where  $b$  is the number of random codes at least as extreme as the standard code and  $M = 10^6$ . A 95% Monte Carlo uncertainty interval is reported with each estimate. The computation is reported in `mc_significance.py` and summarized in `mc_significance.csv`. An independent



implementation, using a different construction of the codon groups, a direct search for Key 1, and a different random seed, reproduces the observed statistics and tail probabilities within the expected Monte Carlo error (`verify_mc.py`).

Six statistical summaries are considered. S1 tests the joint divisibility of two anchors:  $N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 3589 = 97 \cdot 37$  and  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700 = 100 \cdot 37$ . Both events occur in a fraction 0.000800 of random codes (Monte Carlo 95% interval 0.000746–0.000856). This is the directly estimated joint probability; no assumption that the two events are independent is used in its calculation.

S2 counts divisibility by 37 among the four quantities  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , and  $\Delta$  for nine sense-pool groups: the full pool, the six chemical-axis half-pools, and the two octets. The standard code has 13 divisible quantities among 36 nominal entries, against a null mean of 1.0299. A value of 13 or greater occurred in 39 of  $10^6$  trials, giving  $p_{MC} = 4.0 \times 10^{-5}$  with a 95% interval of  $2.9 \times 10^{-5}$ – $5.3 \times 10^{-5}$ . The components of the count are dependent:  $T = P + N$ ,  $\Delta = P - N$ , and the Keto/Strong and Amino/Weak groups form exact twin pairs. These dependencies are reproduced in every permutation and are therefore already included in the null distribution of the composite statistic.

S3 applies the same count to the 17 groups that contain no service codon at all, giving 68 nominal entries. The standard code has 14 divisible quantities against a null mean of 2.1311,  $p_{MC} = 0.025135$ , and a 95% interval of 0.024829–0.025443. Eleven of the fourteen divisibilities are structural copies of  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 100 \cdot 37$ , while the remaining three form the pyrimidine  $\Delta$ -cascade ( $\Delta(\text{Pyrimidine}) = 8 \cdot 37$  and  $\Delta(\{C\}) = \Delta(\{T\}) = 4 \cdot 37$ ). S3 therefore records the propagation of two structural cascades and is treated as a secondary summary.

S4sense measures not only exact divisibility but the overall proximity of the sense pool to the lattice of step 37. For each of the 33 groups, the distances of  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , and  $\Delta$  to the nearest multiple of 37 are averaged, with zero included as a distance of zero; 132 quantities are included in total. The standard code has mean distance 4.8182 against a null mean of 9.1495. An equal or smaller distance occurs in a fraction 0.000274 of random codes, with a 95% interval of 0.000242–0.000307. This statistic assigns no values to service codons. Because the summary was defined after inspection of the observed structure, it is treated as an exploratory continuous sensitivity analysis.

S4a applies the same distance under Key 0. In the standard code ATG encodes methionine; in each random code its contribution is the amino acid actually assigned by the permutation to the ATG block, while the stop codons contribute zero. The standard code has mean distance 5.5606 against a null mean of 9.0157,  $p_{MC} = 0.002807$ , and a 95% interval of 0.002704–0.002912. The concentration is therefore already present under the naive Key 0, although Key 0 remains a formal assignment of service-codon values.

S4b tests the Key 1 derivation symmetrically: the standard code and every random code are evaluated under their own minimal non-negative key, derived from the Keto/Amino balance and global divisibility by 37. The fixation of this axis and the compatibility of the conditions are established in Section 3.3.3. The standard code has mean distance 4.6364 against a null mean of 7.7397,  $p_{MC} = 0.021106$ , and a 95% interval of 0.020825–0.021389. Thus the standard code’s Key 1 is moderately atypical among keys re-derived for random codes.

The two most sensitive sense-pool summaries — the discrete S2 and the continuous S4sense — describe the same overall concentration from different directions. Their  $p$ -values are dependent and must not be multiplied or interpreted as two independent lines of evidence. S1 records two individual anchors of the structure, whereas the weaker S3 shows that restriction to groups with no service positions leaves mainly the Octet I and pyrimidine- $\Delta$  cascades.

S4a and S4b address separate questions about the two formal assignments to service codons. S4a shows that the concentration is retained under the naive Key 0. S4b evaluates the entire Key 1 derivation rather than the fixed values of the standard key and gives a more moderate tail probability. The assignment-free sense-pool results therefore form the central statistical part of



the analysis, while S4a and S4b are secondary tests of its extension to the complete table.

All reported  $p_{\text{MC}}$  values are nominal tail probabilities for the individual statistics; no multiplicity correction across the six statistics was applied.

The null model fixes the standard code’s degeneracy architecture and the real paired proton and neutron counts of the amino acids and randomizes only their assignment to blocks. A different generative model would give different probabilities. The modulus 37, the Rumer partition, and the chemical axes have substantive a priori origins, but the choice of global statistical summaries was not preregistered before inspection of the structure. The results therefore characterize the exploratory atypicality of the standard code under one explicit combinatorial model rather than confirming a preregistered hypothesis. Improbability under this null concerns combinatorial codes, a different question from specificity among the 27 natural codes in Section 4.1; it speaks to no biological mechanism.

#### 4.4 Relation to prior work

Three prior contributions are particularly relevant to the arithmetic structure analyzed in this work. Yu. B. Rumer [6, 7] introduced the partition of the 64 codons of the standard code into two equal classes: Octet I consisting of the eight fully degenerate families, and Octet II consisting of the eight heterogeneous families. The two classes are related by the involution  $R = (T \leftrightarrow G, C \leftrightarrow A)$ , under which each family of one class is mapped to a family of the other. Shcherbak and Makukov [8] observed that the number 37 plays a recurrent role in the genetic code, appearing as a divisor of amino acid nucleon sums across various groupings of codons. Panov and Filatov [5] revisited and extended this analysis. They introduced the per-codon counting rule, in which each of the 64 codons contributes independently the nucleon count of the amino acid it encodes. They also proposed that stop codons be assigned a total nucleon count of 74 each rather than zero.

The present work differs from these in several methodological choices. Shcherbak and Makukov, and Panov and Filatov following them, decompose each amino acid into a constant part with nucleon count 74 and a variable side chain, and many of their nucleon sums are formed over side chains alone. This decomposition forces a special treatment of proline, whose cyclic side chain reduces the nucleon count of its constant part to 73 rather than 74: to bring it in line with the other nineteen amino acids, Shcherbak and Makukov introduce a virtual transfer of one nucleon from its side chain to its constant part, an operation they call the *activation key*. The present work uses full amino acid nucleon counts without separation into constant and side-chain components, and the question of how to treat proline does not arise. Shcherbak and Makukov also adopt a counting rule in which each amino acid contributes once per codon family rather than once per codon; Panov and Filatov replace this with the per-codon rule, which the present work also uses. Finally, all nucleon sums in the prior works are formed over the total nucleon count  $T$  (or over its restriction to side chains); the separation of  $T$  into protons  $P$  and neutrons  $N$ , and the analysis of the difference  $\Delta = P - N$ , are introduced in the present work and underlie a class of arguments unavailable when only  $T$  is considered.

The two prior works also differ from ours in the systematics by which codons are grouped. They apply several different grouping schemes in parallel (Gamow’s sorting and others), each tailored to a particular set of patterns. The present work formulates a single grouping system based on the Rumer octets and the third-position chemical axes, and analyzes the arithmetic structure within it consistently. The parametrization of service codons also differs: Shcherbak and Makukov treat stop codons as contributing zero and identify ATG with Met throughout, Panov and Filatov propose in addition the assignment of total nucleon count 74 to stop codons as an alternative, while the present work considers the parametrization of service codons as part of the derivation of Key 1 (Section 3.3). Finally, Shcherbak and Makukov work extensively with the euplotid code variant (in which TGA is reassigned to Cys), which they take as a symmetrized counterpart of the standard code; Panov and Filatov treat this as a switchable alternative. The

present work focuses on the standard code, and compares its arithmetic structure with the 26 alternative NCBI translation tables on equal footing (Sections 4.1, 4.1).

We now describe how the divisibility findings of these prior works project onto the groups defined in the present analysis. Shcherbak and Makukov, counting one molecule per distinct coding role within a family, observed that the sum of amino acid nucleon counts over Octet I is divisible by 37, with  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 925 = 25 \cdot 37$ , and that the same holds for Octet II under the assignment of zero to stop codons, with  $T(\text{Octet II}) = 2220 = 60 \cdot 37$ . Panov and Filatov, having introduced the per-codon counting rule, obtained the corresponding totals under codon-level counting:  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700 = 100 \cdot 37$  and  $T(\text{Octet II}) = 4218 = 114 \cdot 37$  (or  $4440 = 120 \cdot 37$  under their alternative assignment of 74 to stop codons).

The relation between the per-coding-role total and the per-codon total is direct for Octet I, which is fully four-fold degenerate:  $3700 = 4 \cdot 925$ . For Octet II, whose families contain different numbers of distinct coding roles, the per-codon total 4218 is not a multiple of the per-coding-role total 2220 and is an independent fact. The per-coding-role total 2220 itself coincides with  $T(\text{Keto} \cap \text{Octet II}) = T(\text{Strong} \cap \text{Octet II})$  in our analysis: the universal pyrimidine synonymy within Octet II (Section 3.1.3) implies that the sixteen codons of Keto (or of Strong) intersected with Octet II contain each coding role exactly once, so their per-codon total equals the per-coding-role total.

From these primary facts, the divisibility by 37 of several further groups in our systematics follows trivially. The total over the entire code is the sum of the two octet totals; the sixteen-codon and eight-codon sub-groups of Octet I are mutually identical by four-fold degeneracy; and the four chemical-axis groups Keto, Strong, Amino, Weak each decompose into an Octet I sixteen-codon sub-group and an Octet II sixteen-codon sub-group, of which the first is automatically divisible by 37 and the second reduces to a separate question addressed in the present work.

## 4.5 Limitations and outlook

The statistical significance of the observed arithmetic regularities is assessed in Section 4.3 under one explicit null — the random-code permutation, which fixes the code’s degeneracy architecture and the amino-acid nucleon counts and randomizes only the assignment of amino acids to codon families. Under that null the headline divisibility count and the continuous concentration over the full sense pool are highly atypical. The narrower S3 test, restricted to nested groups that contain no service codon at all, is only weakly atypical ( $p_{\text{MC}} \approx 0.025$ ) and mainly reflects copies of the Octet I total. The choice of null is not unique: alternative generative models, for example randomizing the block sizes themselves or the nucleon counts, would probe different aspects of the regularity and are left for future work, as is any account of a mechanism that could produce it.

The parametrization of service codons in the present work is restricted to Key 0 and Key 1; additional parametric assignments are tabulated in `key_parameters.csv` and in the accompanying `visualization.html` for illustration of other choices.

A further direction concerns the group-theoretic structure of the codon table. Following Panov and Filatov [5], to each of the 24 orderings of the four bases on the axes of the codon matrix we associate its *calligram*: the geometric pattern formed by the eight homogeneous codon families of Octet I on the  $4 \times 4$  matrix. Connectedness of an octet refers to the connectedness of this pattern under 4-adjacency of matrix cells. Among the 24 calligrams, Panov and Filatov [5] identified four — CTGA, CGTA, ATGC, and AGTC — in which each of the Rumer octets forms a connected region, and showed that these four form a closed set under the transformations  $R = (T \leftrightarrow G, C \leftrightarrow A)$ ,  $R_1 = (T \leftrightarrow G)$ , and  $R_2 = (C \leftrightarrow A)$ . These three transformations together with the identity form the Klein four-group  $V_4$ , and the action of  $V_4$  extends naturally to the full set of 24 calligrams. This action of  $V_4$  on the full set of 24 calligrams is free, partitioning it into six orbits of four calligrams each. Exactly one of these six orbits consists of connected calligrams, accounting for the four calligrams above; the remaining five orbits contain no connected calligram. This connected orbit furthermore contains the canonical chemical ordering  $C, G, T, A$  of Rumer [7]

(Section 2.2); the correspondence between this chemical ordering and the geometric property of connectedness is non-automatic, since only two of the eight chemically alternating orderings of the four bases yield connected octets. The search for further structural invariants distinguishing the orbits — and for connections between the group-theoretic orbits and the arithmetic systematics of the present work — is left to future investigation.

## 5 Conclusion

The standard genetic code exhibits arithmetic regularities visible at several levels of parametric specificity. A first layer is independent of any choice of nucleon contributions for the service codons, and it carries the central finding of this work: summed over the sixty sense codons, the neutron pool is an exact multiple of the modulus,  $N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 3589 = 97 \cdot 37$ , while the proton pool falls one unit short of an odd multiple,  $P(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) \equiv -1 \pmod{37}$ —a property of the proton/neutron split that is invisible at the level of the total count  $T$ . Two further parametrization-independent facts sit alongside it. The eight families of Octet I carry  $T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700 = 100 \cdot 37$ , with  $P(\text{Octet I}) = 2000$  and  $N(\text{Octet I}) = 1700$ , the latter combining with the Octet II sense pool as  $1700 + 1889 = 3589$ ; and the entire Keto/Amino asymmetry of the code localizes, after exclusion of the service codons, to the single amino-acid pair Trp–Ile, with  $|\delta N| = 37$  and  $|\delta P| = 36$ . The universal pyrimidine synonymy within Octet II produces identities between the twin sixteen-codon groups Keto/Strong and Amino/Weak within Octet II.

A second layer arises under the naive reading, where the proton and neutron counts  $P$  and  $N$  are analyzed separately. The total nucleon count  $T$  is divisible by 37 for the four chemical-axis groups and for Octet II. For the Amino and Weak groups,  $P$  and  $N$  are individually divisible by 37, aligning these groups with the lattice of step 37 along both axes.

A third layer introduces the service-codon assignment. There is a unique minimal non-negative integer assignment, Key 1 (Section 3.3), under which the parametrization-independent structure extends to the full 64-codon table. Key 1 is not a foundation for the findings above but a device that renders them on the complete table: the same sense-pool divisibility, the same localized pair, and the same proton parity that hold with the service codons unassigned are exactly what make the assignment solvable in small integers. The neutron balance across the Keto/Amino axis reproduces the Trp–Ile difference  $|\delta N| = 37$ ; the global neutron deficit  $T(\text{Octet I}) - N(\mathcal{C}_{SE}) = 111 = 3 \cdot 37$  closes because it is a common multiple of the number of stops and the modulus; the even-proton parity theorem forbids  $|\delta P| = 37$  and bars the sense-pool proton pool from the odd multiples of the modulus, so that it sits one unit below—by a margin that the specific nucleon counts make exactly one—which the start codon’s minimal contribution  $p_{\text{start}} = 1$  restores; and  $\gcd(4, 37) = 1$  leaves a unique minimal solution. None of these is a parametric assumption; each is an empirical property of the standard code established at the parametrization-independent level, and Key 1 exists as the minimal extension precisely because they hold simultaneously.

Under the derived parametrization, the arithmetic regularities organize into a connected family: alignment of the four chemical-axis groups along the axes  $T$ ,  $P$ ,  $N$ , and  $\Delta$  (Section 3.4.1), macroscopic identities including  $N(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet I}) = 3700$  and  $P(\text{All}) = T(\text{Octet II}) = 4292$  (Section 3.4.2), the uniform invariant  $\Delta = 296$  across all six 32-codon groups (Section 3.4.4), and divisibility patterns by 37 and 999 at multiple levels of partitioning (Section 3.4.3). The comparative analysis across the 27 NCBI translation tables (Section 4.1) shows that the simultaneous holding of all structural preconditions enumerated above is a property of the standard code alone.

Two features of this structure constrain how it may be read. First, the regularities reside in group sums rather than in individual molecules: no single canonical amino acid has a nucleon count divisible by 37, and in groups of variable coding degeneracy, such as Amino, the divisibility holds only when codons are counted with their multiplicity and fails when each amino acid is counted once. The nucleon composition and the degeneracy of coding are therefore not independent quantities within this structure: the regularity is a joint property of how nucleon

mass is distributed and how many codons each amino acid receives. Second, the entire first layer above, including the values over Octet I and the twin-group identities, is established with the service codons carrying no nucleon values at all; the derived parametrization of the service codons enters only at the later layers and does not affect the parameter-independent results. The assigned values are thus a device for exhibiting the arithmetic of the complete table, not a foundation on which the principal findings rest.

The specificity established by the comparison across natural codes is complemented by deterministic controls and by a Monte Carlo analysis. The controls show that divisibilities concentrate in third-position groupings and that 37 stands out among the tested prime moduli. Under an explicit random-code null that fixes the degeneracy architecture and permutes the twenty real paired proton and neutron profiles over the twenty blocks, two dependent sense-pool summaries place the standard code in the far tail: the discrete S2 count gives  $p_{MC} = 4.0 \times 10^{-5}$ , and the S4sense mean distance gives  $p_{MC} = 2.74 \times 10^{-4}$ . The narrower S3 test, restricted to groups that contain no service codon at all, is only weakly atypical ( $p_{MC} \approx 0.025$ ) and mainly reflects dependent copies of the divisibility of  $T(\text{Octet I})$ . The concentration persists under Key 0 ( $p_{MC} \approx 0.0028$ ), whereas the symmetric test of the Key 1 derivation gives moderate atypicality ( $p_{MC} \approx 0.021$ ). These probabilities refer to different, dependent summaries and are not combined by multiplication. This is improbability under one combinatorial null, distinct from the specificity among the 27 natural codes, and it speaks to no biological mechanism; alternative null models are left for future work.

The methodological choice underlying the present work is to restrict attention to parameters whose definition is unambiguous — the total nucleon count  $T$ , its decomposition into protons  $P$  and neutrons  $N$ , and the difference  $\Delta = P - N$  — and to a single grouping system based on the Rumer octets and the third-position chemical axes. The interpretation of the arithmetic facts collected here is left open.

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